CAUSAL MAP GARDEN

Case studies

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🌻 Some Case Studies

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10 Dec 2025

2025-12-10 Here are some examples of work with Causal Map and causal mapping, and also with Qualia interviews.

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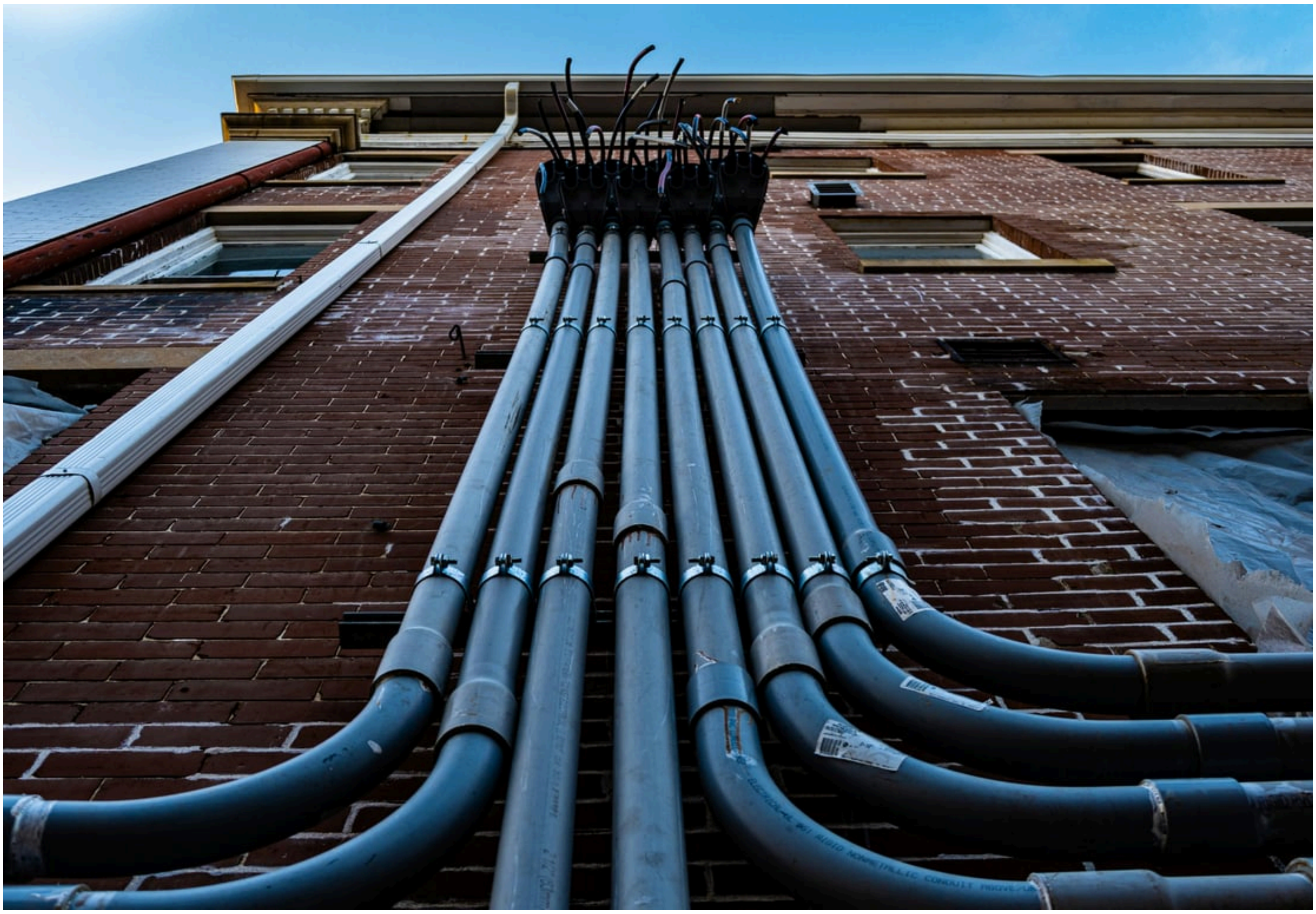
🌻 A workflow for collecting and understanding stories at scale, supported by artificial intelligence

10 Mar 2025



2025-03-10 Paper in Evaluation journal, Steve Powell

Summary

This article presents an artificial intelligence-assisted causal mapping pipeline for gathering and analysing stakeholder perspectives at scale. Evidence relevant to constructing a programme theory, as well as evidence for the causal influences flowing through it, are both collected at the same time, without the evaluator needing to possess a prior theory.

The method uses an artificial intelligence interviewer to conduct interviews, automated coding to identify causal claims in the transcripts, and causal mapping to synthesise and visualise results. The authors tested this approach by interviewing participants about problems facing the United States. Results indicate that the method can efficiently collect and process qualitative data, producing useful causal maps that capture respondents' views.

The article discusses the potential of this approach for evaluation, enabling rapid, large-scale qualitative analysis. It also notes limitations and ethical concerns, emphasising the need for human oversight and verification.

This article Here is the pre-publication version

🌻 AgDevCo, Uganda

19 Sep 2022

2022-09-19

Summary

Understanding the impact of support and training provided to VSLAs through a local agricultural development company in the East Acholi region. 48 individual interviews and 8 focus groups. Carried out by Bath SDR between November 2019 and January 2020.

See the full report here

🌻 AI-assisted causal mapping. Uncovering causal pathways with INTRAC

8 Jan 2026

2026-01-08

The partner

We partnered with INTRAC on a project for the SCC (Strengthening Civil Society) programme. This programme is led by a consortium of four organisations: PAX, ABAAD, DefendDefenders and Amnesty International Netherlands, with INTRAC serving as the MEL partner. INTRAC is a non-profit organisation with a deep commitment to understanding and improving the practice of civil society worldwide.

The challenge

The SCC programme is a complex, multi-year initiative spanning 13 countries. The INTRAC team was using Outcome Harvesting but found themselves struggling to get the 'big picture'. They needed a systematic, yet flexible, way to connect the dots in a large body of qualitative data to answer critical questions about the programme's overarching causal pathways of change.

The core challenge was translating a high volume of text into high-quality, actionable analysis. Alastair Spray, Senior Consultant at INTRAC, led the causal mapping component of the End Term Evaluation. He worked alongside a core team of four, supported by two other colleagues who provided input into the wider evaluation. As Alastair noted:

> *"The client had been pursuing usual evaluation approaches... and had found Outcome Harvesting useful, but they felt that they couldn't understand the big picture, for the whole programme but also for specific countries too."

The team needed to rigorously analyse the data to answer questions such as:

- How have the different levels of Lobby & Advocacy interventions fared (national, international, local)?
- What are the causal stories at the individual country level?
- Are there shifts in causal pathways over time, particularly when comparing the programme's earlier and later years?
- How do the causal pathways link directly to the four specific objectives of the SCC programme?

The Causal Map solution

We used Causal Map's consulting service and our AI-assisted approach to bring clarity and rigour to this complex qualitative data, creating a process that was both systematic and reproducible for INTRAC.

Given the sensitive nature of the SCC programme, we worked closely with the team to ensure all data was thoroughly anonymised before the mapping and analysis began.

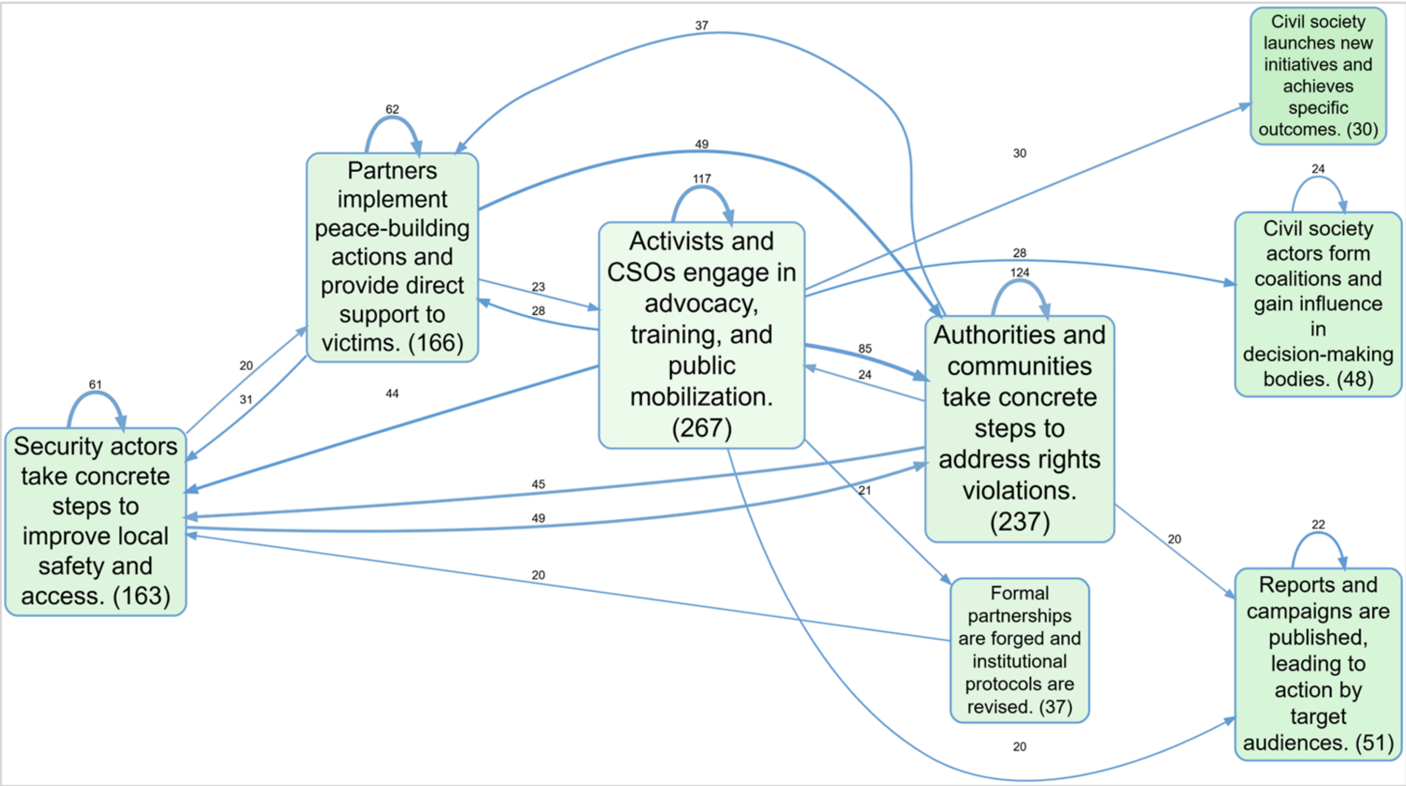
Our approach

1. **Data input:** We processed comprehensive data sources, including Harvested outcomes data from the 13 countries across four programme years, and Narrative Theory of Change Review documents (typically 8–15 pages long) from partner organisations.
2. **AI-Assisted coding:** The Causal Map team was responsible the core coding. We used a radical zero-shot approach with our AI (Gemini 2.5 Pro), which was instructed to invent its own codes based purely on the text. This process quickly identified 5,430 causal claims from the respondents, which were also auto-coded for sentiment (positive/negative links).
3. **Collaborative Analysis:** We provided a preliminary analysis report and materials, along with specific training for Alastair on the cm4 platform. This allowed the INTRAC team to engage directly with the maps and dig deeper into the coding when writing their final report. This hands-on support was crucial for building confidence, which Alastair highlighted:

> *"The team (Steve and Gabriele) are incredibly helpful, and good at training you up on how you might want to use it to interrogate your data. My advice would be to learn by doing, try to get started and then ask for help as you need it, rather than worrying about getting it right from the start."*

Results

The use of Causal Map for this analysis generated a powerful set of visual and analytical outputs, allowing INTRAC to move from raw data to a better understanding of 'what causes what' in their programme.



- **Overall and country-specific maps:** A high-level causal map for the entire programme, along with 13 individual maps, one for each country, to capture localised dynamics.
- **Targeted analysis:** Alastair worked on cresting filtered maps to specifically show outcomes linked to (1) Lobby & Advocacy activities and (2) local ownership, which was a key area of interest for the PAX Head of Programs.
- **Change over time:** By filtering the data into two distinct periods, the team could identify any shifts in causal pathways since the mid-term review.

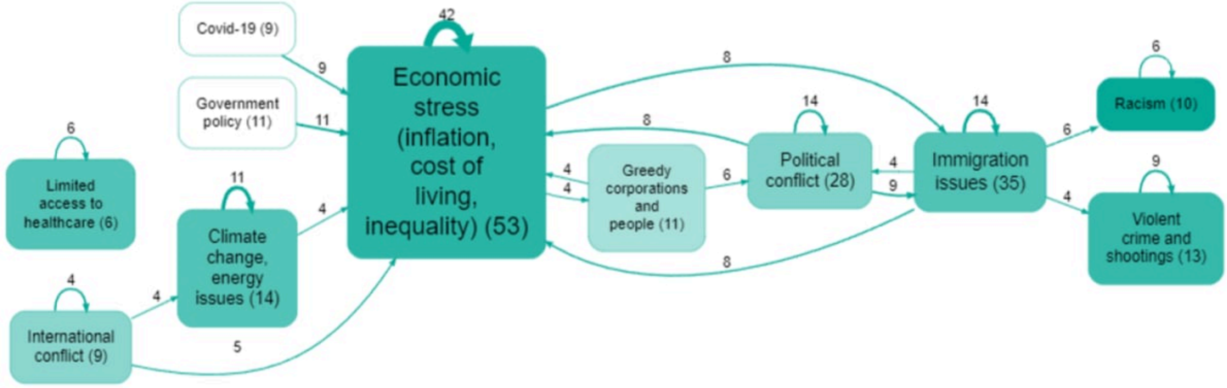
The project provided INTRAC with a robust, visual evidence base that articulated how stakeholders perceived change in the SCC programme, helping them to move from raw data to a deeper understanding of 'what causes what' in their complex field.

See what Alastair has to say:

> “Causal Map really allowed us to get that higher level of understanding, in both a clear visual but also high quality written analysis.”
>
> **On the Causal Map 4 app:** “The app itself is really clear, intuitive (after a lesson of course), and the info/help icons are great.”
>
> **On the AI/Vignettes:** “The vignettes function (using the in-built AI to generate written analysis of the selected causal map) is incredibly useful, and saves a lot of time! Once you get the hang of giving it better and better prompts you inevitably get better results too, […] and the client clearly liked what it churned out too.”
>
> **On the support:** “A small point, but important one, you were both very good at building my confidence in using it! Questions I asked weren’t considered obvious or basic, and the initial attempts at making maps or analysis were met with enthusiasm / encouragement, which on reflection I’m sure made me more keen to use the app. I think it would be easy for a non-tech savy user to get into their own head that ‘they are bad at it’ and that would inevitably affect how (and how much) they actually use it.”
>
> **On the results:** “The analysis I produced from using Causal Map was received very well by the client. It was very useful in validating their approach and theory of change, and they appreciated how clearly the combination of the maps and vignettes revealed exactly what the outcomes were and what had (and hadn’t) caused them.”
>
> — Alastair Spray (Senior Consultant, INTRAC)

🌻 An M&E time machine. Using AI to measure changes in a system across a time period

19 Sep 2023



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Numbers on factors show source count.. Factor sizes show citation count. Darker factor colours show greater outcomeness.
Numbers on links show source count.
Zooming out to level 1 of the hierarchy. Auto clustering factors with granularity of 56% at level 1. Showing only factors with at least 6 sources. Showing only links with at least 4 sources.

2023-09-19

Summary

A proof of concept study about using AI to collect and analyse data in complex systems.

See the paper here

🌻 Cactus Research, Kings College

📅 19 Sep 2022

2022-09-19

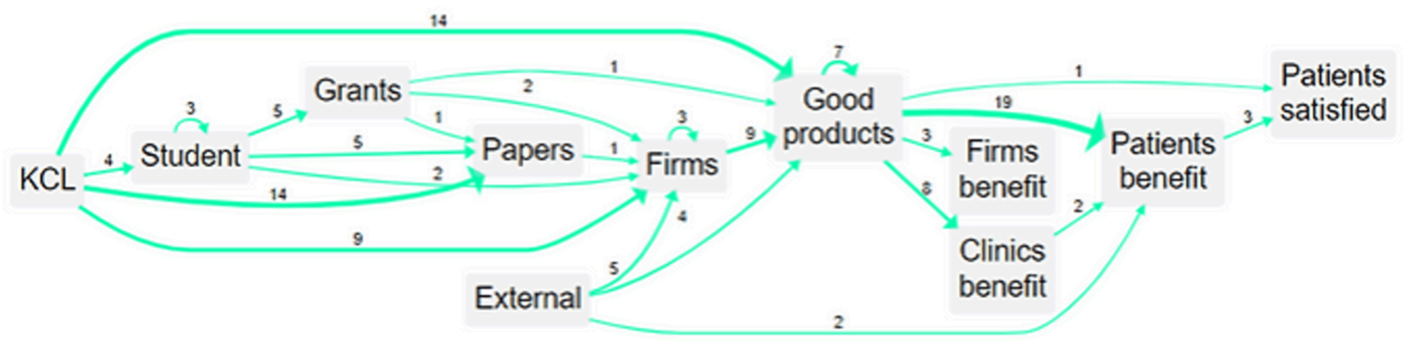
Summary

An analysis of the long-term impact of the scientific work of a University Department, required for the UK REF process. We carried out some interviews and combined this information with existing documentation, publication lists etc to make a causal map of the impact. The study combined data from different sources to trace the impact of the original academic research, into a robot massage system intended to assist medical professionals and patients. Additional interviews were conducted with manufacturers and clinics "downstream" of the research in order to enrich information about the "ripple effect" of the original research via different pathways right across the globe.

The REF is the UK's framework for evaluating research work carried out by universities. One department at King's College London (KCL) engaged Cactus Communications to provide evidence to support an impact case study to be submitted for REF 2021. Cactus in turn engaged Causal Map to collect and synthesise the evidence.

The findings were able to demonstrate a wealth of evidence for research impact. For example there are 15 completely separate threads of evidence from KCL research to benefits to patients. The study also showed the influence of the research in the context of other contributions from other researchers and organisations.

CACTUS® | 20 years



Cactus Communications

🌻 Can AI accurately map causal claims - A validation study

🗓 3 Mar 2026

2026-03-03 _Summarised from "AI-assisted causal mapping: a validation study" by Steve Powell and Gabriele Caldas Cabral.

Extracting causal claims from qualitative interviews is a notoriously slow process. Evaluators spend hours combing through transcripts to work out what respondents think influences what. Generative AI offers a solution, but a critical question remains. Is an untrained AI assistant actually any good at identifying and labelling these causal links compared to human experts?

We conducted a validation study to find out. The results show that treating AI as a tireless, low-level coding assistant works surprisingly well.

The approach: naive causal coding

We used a pragmatic, minimalist approach to causation. We did not ask the AI to model complex systems, determine the strength of causal effects, or make predictions. We simply asked it to identify evidence of causal influence within the text.

The task was reduced to a clear set of instructions: read the text, find the causal claims, and tell us what influences what. By asking the AI only to extract claims rather than interpret their ultimate validity, we keep the human evaluator firmly in charge of the actual analysis.

The experiment

We used a dataset from a Qualitative Impact Protocol (QuIP) study evaluating an agriculture and nutrition programme. Expert human analysts had already coded these transcripts by hand. This provided our benchmark.

We took a subset of the data (163 statements from three sources) and instructed GPT-4.0 to code it. The AI processed the text statement by statement, extracting the cause, the effect, and the verbatim quote proving the claim. We ran the test in two ways:

1. Radical zero-shot: The AI was given research context but no codebook or suggested labels. It had to invent its own factor labels.

2. Closed coding: The AI was provided with a basic codebook of 29 top-level labels derived from the prior human coding.**

The Results: high precision and high recall

The AI performed at a level comparable to a human assistant. We evaluated the results on both precision (were the links correct?) and recall (did it find all the links?).

- Precision: Without a codebook, 84% of the causal links identified by the AI were rated as perfectly correct across four strict criteria. When given a basic codebook, this precision rate rose to 87%. The errors the AI did make were usually minor labelling discrepancies or ‘noise’ rather than complete misunderstandings of the text.
- Recall: The AI successfully identified approximately as many valid causal links as the human experts. In some transcripts, it actually found valid links that the human coders had missed.

The bigger picture: comparing the maps

In qualitative data analysis, two human coders rarely produce the exact same set of detailed labels. The AI was no different. The raw, detailed maps produced by the AI and the humans differed in specific terminology.

However, evaluation rarely relies on looking at every single microscopic link. When we zoomed out to create high-level overview maps showing the most frequently mentioned factors and links, the structures were very similar to each other.

Figure 1: Overview causal map generated from AI coding.

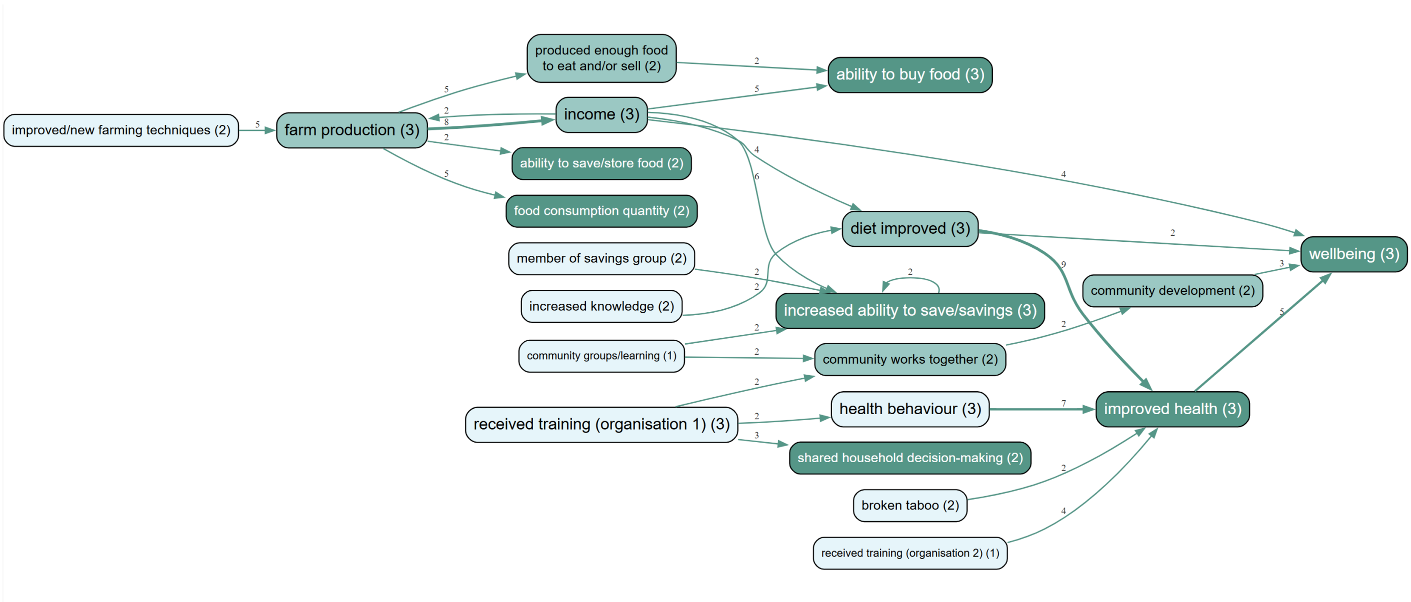
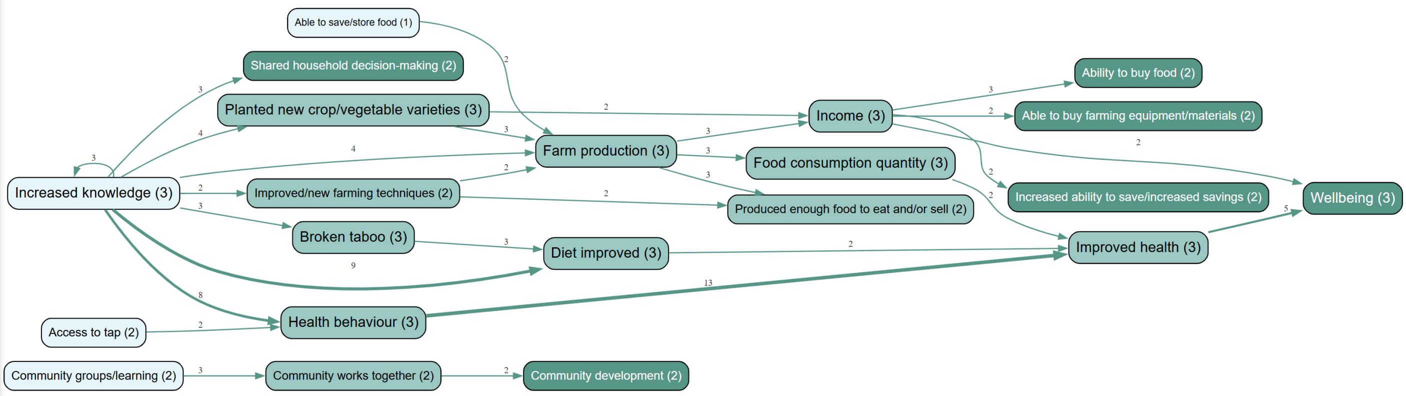


Figure 2: Overview causal map generated from human expert coding.



The AI map and the human map told the same overarching story. The AI tended to prefer labels like "received training", whereas the human coders preferred "increased knowledge", but both were perfectly reasonable interpretations of the underlying text.

The verdict

Generative AI is highly capable of extracting causal claims from qualitative data. Using a naive approach to causal coding, AI achieved a precision rate well over 80% GPT-4.0, which is now an outdated model.

This does not turn the AI into a black box that replaces the evaluator. Instead, the AI functions as a transparent assistant. It does the heavy lifting of initial extraction, reading through pages of text to pull out claims and attach the exact quotes that prove them. This allows evaluators to process qualitative data rapidly and at scale, freeing up time for the human judgment and synthesis that actually matters.

🌻 Chartered Management Institute

📅 19 Sep 2022

2022-09-19

Summary

Series of qualitative causal analyses of structured questions in four manager surveys on inclusion in the workplace, for CMI's 75th anniversary.

Chartered Management Institute hired Causal Map to seek their members' views on how protected characteristics impact on progression in management roles. A series of qualitative causal analyses of structured questions in four manager surveys on inclusion in the workplace were conducted. Five reports on different areas were created: Ethnic, Socio, Gender, Disability and Age.

The reports explored how good modern management and leadership practices can help workplaces to embrace diversity towards the five areas above. Also, the study was able to find areas where there has been less progress and the reasons for that.

Questions answered by the study included: What works in implementing inclusive recruitment and progression practice? What are the challenges in current inclusive practices in the organisation? How can workplaces become more inclusive for different ages?

🌻 Comparing a Fine-Tuned Model to an Engineered Prompt in the Context of Causal Connections in a Passage of Text

1 Sep 2023

2023-09-01

Summary

Samuel Goddard, a student at the MSc in Data Science at the University of Bath, compared the performance of a fine-tuned OpenAI model and an engineered prompt in identifying causal connections within text passages to determine the more effective approach for automating this task for Causal Map's software.

See the full thesis here

🌻 Concern Worldwide, Malawi

19 Sep 2022

2022-09-19

Summary

This was a longitudinal evaluation of Concern Worldwide's Graduation model project over three years. Graduation programmes support people living in extreme and often chronic poverty. Concern provide sequenced and tailored packages of support to help people address the barriers they face to moving out of poverty, from situations often defined by food insecurity and high levels of vulnerability towards sustainable livelihoods.

Request the report from BSDR (info@bathsdr.org).

🌻 Creative Home Delivery Service, PSU

22 Mar 2024

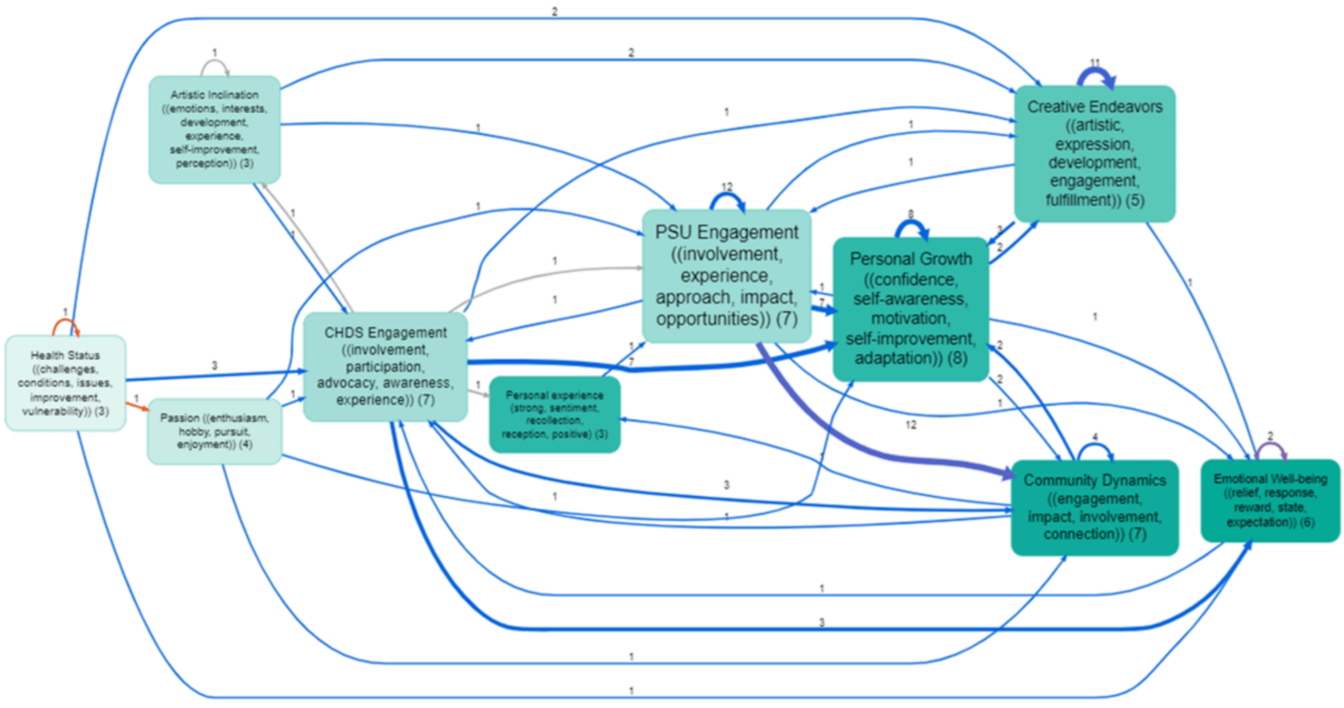
2024-03-22

Summary

Creative Home Delivery service is an arts and health project to alleviate loneliness and isolation and improve wellbeing through creative arts. Designed and facilitated by People Speak Up (PSU), in partnership with Connecting Carmarthenshire, Carmarthenshire County Council and Hywel DDA Health Board. Working with 12 creative artists (movement, singing, creative writing, storytelling, visual arts, spoken word).

In March 2024, PSU commissioned Causal Map to identify the project's impact pathways by analysing interviews with the project's key informants.

The CM team used AI to identify each and every causal link in the interviews to create causal maps.



Filename: psu-chd. Citation coverage 43%: 110 of 253 total citations and 8 of 8 total coded sources are shown here.
Numbers on factors show source count.. Factor sizes show citation count. Darker factor colours show greater outcomeness.
Numbers on links show citation count.
Zooming in to level 1 of the hierarchy. Auto clustering factors using label set 3. Top 10 factors by source count.

Check out the project's page here See Causal Map's findings presentation here

🌻 Diageo, Kenya

📅 19 Sep 2022

2022-09-19

Summary

Diageo have conducted several evaluations into the impact of their raw materials sourcing and agricultural programmes.

Request the report from BSDR (info@bathsdr.org).

🌻 DUOC UC. Evaluating Gender Equity in STEM with AI-Driven Interviews

📅 15 Jan 2026

2026-01-15 06/08/2024

The partner

In 2024, we collaborated with researchers at **DuocUC**, a leading higher education institution in Chile. The project was led by **Felipe Rivera**, Head of Academic Quality Evaluation and **Javiera Cienfuegos**, a Senior Researcher at DuocUC and they focused on understanding and improving the educational landscape for women in technical and professional fields.

The challenge

DuocUC needed to conduct a qualitative, explorative evaluation of the gender gaps faced by women pursuing STEM (Science, Technology, Engineering, and Mathematics) careers at the university.

Traditional qualitative methods often struggle to scale while maintaining the depth required to uncover complex social issues. The team needed a way to collect authentic, personal narratives from a large group of students and then rigorously analyse that data to understand the underlying causal drivers of gender discrimination.

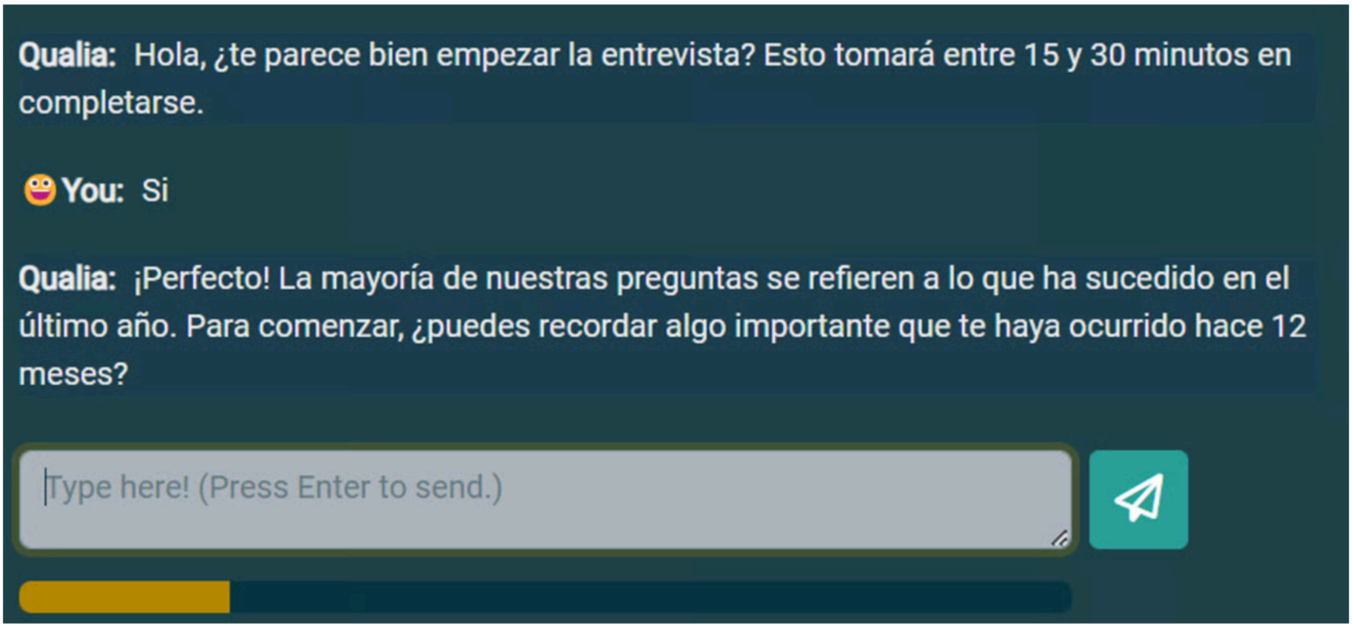
The Causal Map solution

We deployed our "Seamless Stories" workflow—an end-to-end, AI-supported process that combines **QualiaInterviews** for data collection and **Causal Map** for systematic analysis. This approach allowed the university to move from research questions to high-quality visual maps much faster than traditional manual coding, without sacrificing the nuance of the students' lived experiences.

Our approach

We had a first meeting to understand what they wanted to find out, their research questions and the scope of the study and to determine the domains in which the interviews would be conducted.

1. **Automated Data Collection (Qualia):** We designed a responsive, chat-based interview in Spanish using QuIP-style questions. Our AI interviewer, Qualia, powered by GPT-4o, was instructed to explore three key domains: educational experiences, professional development, and relationship dynamics. Out of 50 students invited, 32 completed the conversational interviews.



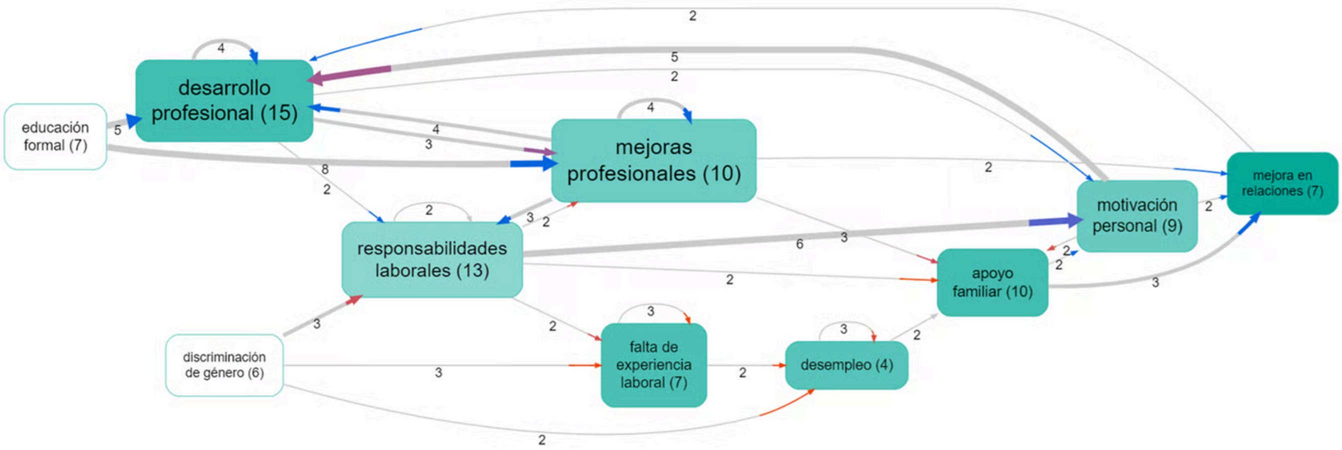
2. **Radical Zero-Shot AI Coding:** Once the interviews were completed, the transcripts were uploaded to Causal Map, and we used a "radical zero-shot" approach to code the data using GPT-4o. The AI was given no pre-defined codebook; instead, it was instructed to "invent" its own codes based purely on the students' narratives (in Spanish). This process identified 251 distinct causal links.

3. **Targeted Research Analysis:** We used Causal Map's filtering tools to interrogate the data and answer specific research questions, such as "What is the immediate impact of gender discrimination?" and "What are the most mentioned causal factors?" We also used the "AI Answers" feature to generate summaries of the broader text independently of the causal coding.

Results

The project provided DuocUC with a visual, evidence-based understanding of the "causal network" surrounding gender discrimination in their STEM programmes.

- **Sentiment-coded maps:** We auto-coded the sentiment of every link, using blue arrows for positive contributions and red for negative ones, allowing the researchers to see exactly where the "friction points" were in the students' journeys.
- **Sythesis:** The workflow transformed 32 in-depth interviews into manageable causal maps, making it easy to identify the most frequent factors mentioned by respondents.
- **Actionable insights:** By filtering the maps, the team could isolate specific pathways of change, helping DuocUC to validate where their current interventions were working and where new support was needed.



See what Javiera has to say:

> "The type of questions that were asked "what causes what", were equally linked to methodological innovation. The results were able to portray how gender barriers are intertwined in domains ranging from higher STEM education to the performance of new professionals and technicians once they enter the labour market, reaching deeper explanations and social impact." — Javiera Cienfuegos (Senior Researcher, DuocUC)

🌻 Everyone Counts, Covid Edition. Chapter 6, On the Front Line, Stories of the Volunteers

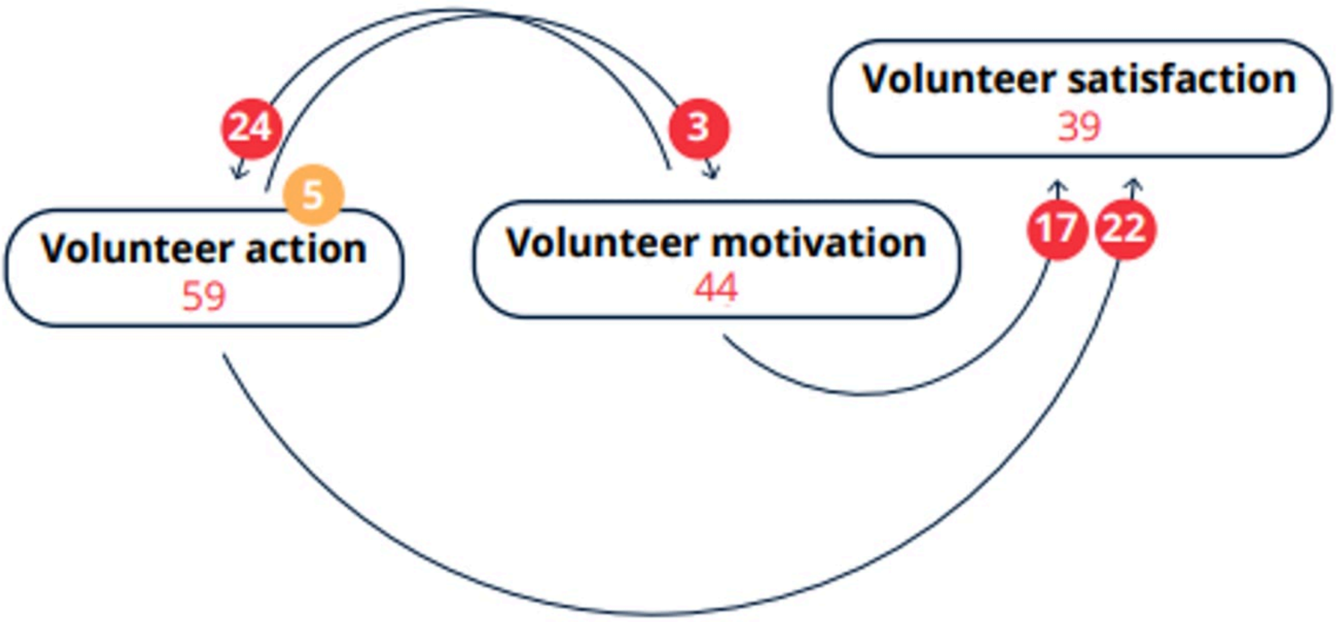
4 Jan 2023

2023-01-04

Summary

Background: The IFRC is a worldwide humanitarian aid organization that reaches 160 million people each year through its 192-member National Societies. "Everyone Counts" is an annual flagship publication of the IFRC. Chapter 6 of the Covid Edition presents causal maps which summarise the experience of volunteers during the pandemic. Work on the chapter was led by Steve Powell who was also lead consultant for the whole report.

Approach: The Solferino Academy invited volunteers around the world to submit their stories. The stories were translated into English and analysed using causal mapping: a kind of qualitative data analysis in which analysts identify passages of text where people talk about how one thing influenced another, rather than looking for general themes as in traditional qualitative data analysis.



See the full report here

🌻 Exploring the Role of Social Protection in UK Asylum-Seeker Wellbeing Using Human Scale Development Theory

28 Aug 2025

Summary

Michelle James and Rachel Forrester-Jones wrote an article in the International Migration section of the Social Sciences journal, in which they used Causal Map to analyse qualitative data to understand the impact of government and community-based social protection (SP) on UK asylum-seeker wellbeing and how interactions with all forms of SP are supporting or harming the satisfaction of asylum-seekers' fundamental human needs.

social sciences

MDPI

Article

Exploring the Role of Social Protection in UK Asylum-Seeker Wellbeing Using Human Scale Development Theory

Michelle James [1,*] and Rachel Forrester-Jones [2]

[1] Department of Social & Policy Sciences, University of Bath, Bath BA2 7JP, UK
[2] School of Health Studies, Faculty of Health Sciences, Western University, London, ON N6A 3K7, Canada; rforre@uwo.ca
* Correspondence: mj773@bath.ac.uk

Abstract

This article utilises Max-Neef's Human Scale Development (HSD) framework (1991) to answer two research questions: what impact does government and community-based social protection (SP) have on UK asylum-seeker wellbeing; how are interactions with all forms of SP, both as giver and receiver, supporting or harming the satisfaction of asylum-seekers' fundamental human needs at this time? The research study utilised a mixed-methods, collaborative, case study design situated within a refugee and asylum-seeker (RAS) support charity in Southwest England. Methods included peer-led Qualitative Impact Protocol interviews, Photovoice, surveys, and staff interviews. Data were subjected to an inductive, bottom-up process on Causal Map software (version 2, Causal Map Ltd., 39 Apsley Rd., Bath BA1 3LP, UK) and the analysis used the HSD framework. We found eight over-arching themes. The four main needs-violators/destroyers of asylum-seeker wellbeing were dehumanisation, unfreedoms, enforced ignorance, and (re)traumatisation, and the four main needs-satisfiers were common humanity, autonomy and resistance, exerting agency through knowledge exchange, and healing. Five policy and practice-focused bridging satisfiers are recommended to help move individual and collective experience from a negative to a positive state in the research population. Policy and practice should be transparent and evidence-based, efficient and equitable, supportive of participation and productivity, trauma-informed, and multi-agency.

Abstract

This article utilises Max-Neef's Human Scale Development (HSD) framework (1991) to answer two research questions: what impact does government and community-based social protection (SP) have on UK asylum-seeker wellbeing; how are interactions with all forms of SP, both as giver and receiver, supporting or harming the satisfaction of asylum-seekers' fundamental human needs at this time?

The research study utilised a mixed-methods, collaborative, case study design situated within a refugee and asylum-seeker (RAS) support charity in Southwest England. Methods included peer-led Qualitative Impact Protocol interviews, Photovoice, surveys, and staff interviews. Data were subjected to an inductive, bottom-up process on Causal Map software and the analysis used the HSD framework.

We found eight over-arching themes. The four main needs-violators/destroyers of asylum-seeker wellbeing were dehumanisation, unfreedoms, enforced ignorance, and (re)traumatisation, and the four main needs-satisfiers were common humanity, autonomy and resistance, exerting agency through knowledge exchange, and healing.

Five policy and practice-focused bridging satisfiers are recommended to help move individual and collective experience from a negative to a positive state in the research population. Policy and practice should be transparent and evidence-based, efficient and equitable, supportive of participation and productivity, trauma-informed, and multi-agency.

Keywords: asylum seeker; refugee; social protection; wellbeing; social policy; human-scale development

Access the article here

Reference (APA): James, M., & Forrester-Jones, R. (2025). Exploring the Role of Social Protection in UK Asylum-Seeker Wellbeing Using Human Scale Development Theory. Social Sciences, 14(8), 474.

🌻 Fairtrade, Cote D'Ivoire

📅 **19 Sep 2022**

2022-09-19

Summary

This QuIP study, conducted by Bath SDR, looked at the impact of Fairtrade co-operatives on Cocoa farmers in Cote D'Ivoire. The data was collected through a partnership with Fairtrade and On Our Radar. 42 participants were engaged in conversations regarding various domains such as agriculture and environmental issues via text messages over 4 months. The data was analysed and presented using the Causal Map app.

See the full report here

🌻 Feed the Children, Kenya

19 Sep 2022

2022-09-19

Summary

This evaluation assessed whether Feed the Children's objectives among the adolescent girls were being achieved. The study targeted girls aged between 10 and 19 years old, in and out of school, who had received food consumption and reproductive health messages in their schools through health club activities or from the peer-to-peer groups within their communities where mothers learn how to practice optimum nutrition behaviours.

See a blog post about the study See a presentation about the study

🌻 ForumFed. Strengthening Federal Governance and Pluralism in Ethiopia

1 Jan 2023

2023

Summary

The Forum of Federations (ForumFed) is an international organisation supporting good governance in federal and decentralising countries. Causal Map provided causal mapping consultancy for a project on strengthening federal governance and pluralism in Ethiopia.

🌻 GirlEffect, Rwanda

19 Sep 2022

2022-09-19

Summary

The focus of this study was on sexual and reproductive health (SRH) work, specifically on behaviours on the journey towards the ultimate goal of girls practising safe sex when ready.

Request the report from BSDR (info@bathsdr.org).

🌻 GYA, Global Young Academy

19 Sep 2022

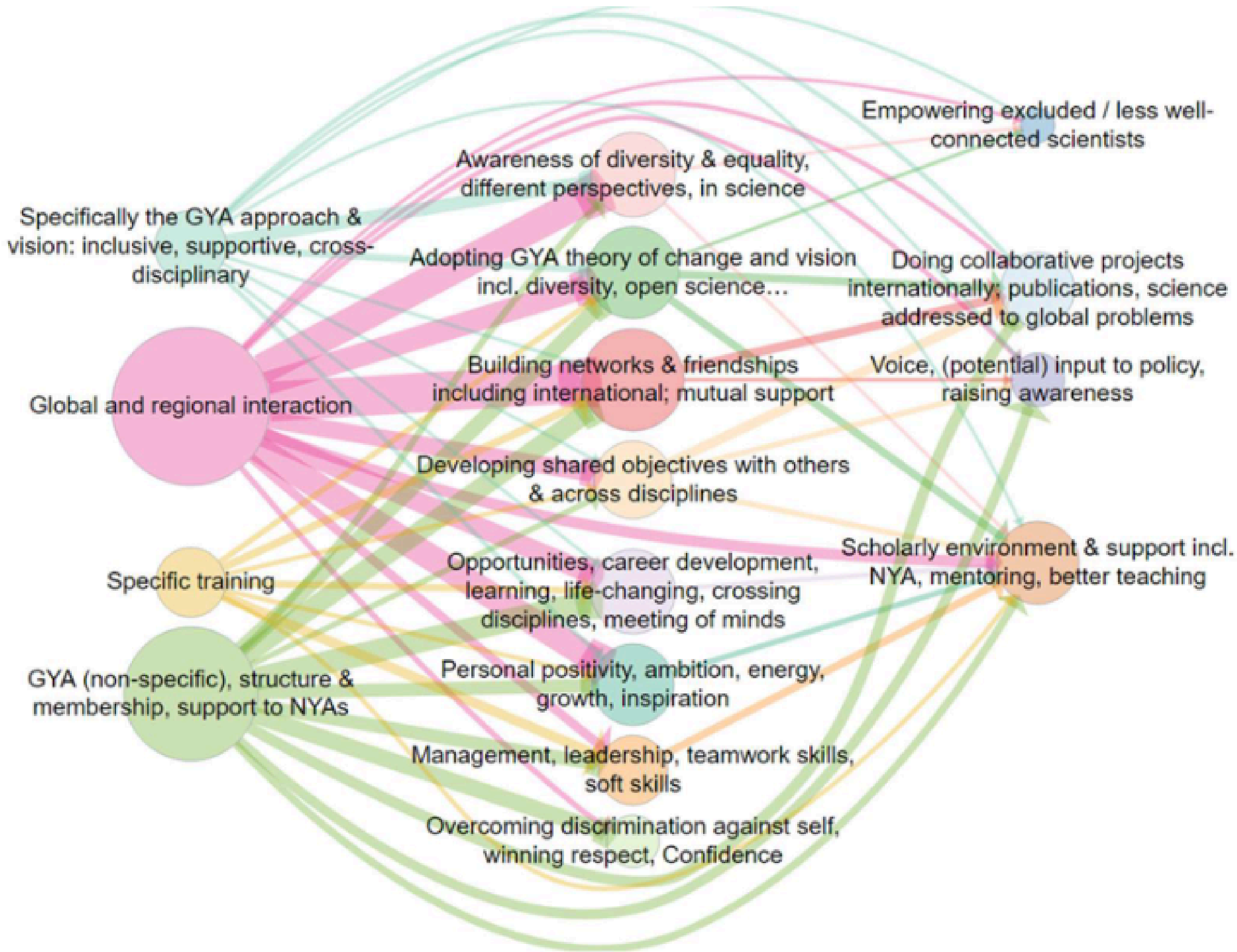
2022-09-19

Summary

This report used a very early version of Causal Map.

Background: The Global Young Academy supports young scientists around the world to connect with other young scientists, develop their careers and work towards solving global problems with science. GYA's 10-year anniversary was an opportunity to reflect on what has been accomplished so far and to inform the strategic plan to increase impact for the next 10 years. An impact evaluation was commissioned to understand personal narratives of impact and to generate data to inform the development of the next 5-year strategic plan.

Approach: We asked over 100 people to tell us stories about positive changes which had happened because of GYA activities. Of the 683 people reached, 103 completed the survey. We analysed the stories looking for examples of where people had said that one thing leads to another. Then all the causes and effects were grouped into themes to create a Theory of Change for GYA. All the individual stories were synthesised into one story using a pre-defined set of analysis steps.



GLOBAL YOUNG ACADEMY

See the full report here

🌻 Kantar Public

19 Sep 2022

2022-09-19

Summary

Kantar Public works with clients around the world, providing rigorous evidence, insights and advisory services to inspire the next generation of public policy and programmes. Causal Map app was used in their SWaN (Strengths, Weaknesses and Needs) QuIP study, with coding and analysis carried out via Bath SDR.

🌻 Mannion Daniels

19 Sep 2022

2022-09-19

Summary

This QuIP study explored the impact of FCDO support to the Nepalese health sector. It was conducted by Mannion Daniels, Bath SDR supported in a consultancy capacity.

🌻 MK Institut, Mission und Kirche

1 Jan 2025

2025

Summary

MK Institut (Mission und Kirche) commissioned Causal Map to carry out causal mapping and 171 Qualia interviews, combining AI-assisted interviewing with qualitative causal analysis at scale.

🌻 Nepal Earthquake Federation-wide Meta-evaluation

📅 19 Sep 2022

2022-09-19

Summary

Nepal Earthquake Federation-wide Meta-evaluation: IFRC. Steve Powell (2020)

This report, written by Steve Powell, used an early version of Causal Map.

Background: After the powerful earthquake which struck Nepal in April 2015, the International Red Cross Red and Crescent Movement mobilized the full range of their resources to support the relief and recovery efforts. NRCS, IFRC and in-country Participating National Societies agreed that individual partners would conduct their own final evaluations, rather than a combined final evaluation. So it was proposed to also conduct a meta-evaluation of the individual final evaluations together with all other reviews and thematic studies conducted 2015 to 2019.

Approach: A central part of the report was a qualitative synthesis of the summaries of over 30 evaluative reports. The design was partially deductive because some main high-level causal factors like Actions and Outcomes were pre-determined, and partly inductive because many lower-level factors were identified within these high-level groups. The focus was on the executive summary and conclusions sections of the primary documents, as these already represent an effort by the respective authors to summarise their own documents.

IFRC

IFRC

See the report here

🌻 OPM, Ghana, Mastercard

19 Sep 2022

2022-09-19

Summary

This QuIP looked at the impact of Savings at the Frontier (SatF) in improving financial inclusion. SatF is a partnership between Mastercard Foundation and OPM that aims to improve the financial inclusion of low-income individuals and communities in sub-Saharan Africa. This study built on and was informed by other QuIP studies conducted between 2019 and 2022, across Zambia, Tanzania and Ghana.

Request the report from BSDR (info@bathsdr.org).

Oxford Policy Management

See the project's page

🌻 OPM, Tanzania

19 Sep 2022

2022-09-19

Summary

Savings at the Frontier was a partnership between Mastercard Foundation and OPM that aimed to improve the financial inclusion of low-income individuals and communities in sub-Saharan Africa.

This was research into microfinance projects in Tanzania.

See the project's page

🌻 OPM, Zambia

19 Sep 2022

2022-09-19

Summary

This study in Zambia focused on the agency and mobile banking services offered by Madison Finance (a partner of Savings at the Frontier) to savings groups and their members. It aims to contribute to an improved understanding of the pathways of change in the processes and dynamics of saving groups and their individual members.

See the project's page

🌻 Opportunity International, Ghana

19 Sep 2022

2022-09-19

Summary

A mid-term and final evaluation of the DFID-funded programme 'Roots of Change: Increasing the economic empowerment of women in Ghana and the DRC through rural financing'.

Request the report from BSDR (info@bathsdr.org).

🌻 Partner Ring, ACI, Australia

5 Jul 2023

2023-07-05

Summary

The Partner Ring was created in 2022 by the Agency for Clinical Innovation (ACI), which is part of the public health infrastructure in New South Wales, Australia. The initiative aimed to enhance the ability of staff to engage effectively. As a consumer-driven project, it served as an example of authentic consumer leadership within the healthcare system and sought to bridge the divide between staff knowledge and practical application in engagement.

The ACI worked with Causal Map to design the interview instructions for Qualia (formerly known as StorySurvey) to collect qualitative data from the Partner Ring's members and then analyse the impact pathways of the programme in Causal Map, using AI in both processes.

See the full paper here

🌻 Pilot Universal Child Benefit Programme in Kenya, UNICEF Kenya

10 Mar 2025

2025-03-10 Gabriele Caldas

Summary

In response to the COVID-19 pandemic, the Government of the Republic of Kenya piloted a Universal Child Benefit (UCB) Programme with support from UNICEF from December 2021 to December 2022, targeting children aged 0–36 months in Kajiado, Embu and Kisumu Counties. The UCB pilot provided KES 800 per month per child, distributed bi-monthly via M-Pesa to female caregivers, and included complementary services to address malnutrition, negative parenting practices and disability exclusion. A qualitative study assessed the pilot's implementation, accessibility, impact and sustainability, using interviews and focus groups to inform future policy development and scale-up opportunities. The study uses QuIP methodology and Causal Map.

Download the report here.

🌻 Power to Change, UK, 2020

19 Sep 2020

2020-09-19

Summary

Power to Change UK: Evaluation of Power to Change investments and activities designed to build capacity and organisational resilience in community businesses (CB). 14 remote interviews carried out between January and February 2020.

See the report here

🌻 Power to Change, UK, 2021

15 Sep 2021

2021-09-15

Summary

Power to Change UK: A second study looking to gather evidence on the role capacity building plays in the development of community businesses. April to May 2021.

See the full report here

🌻 Save the Children, Zimbabwe

19 Sep 2022

2022-09-19

Summary

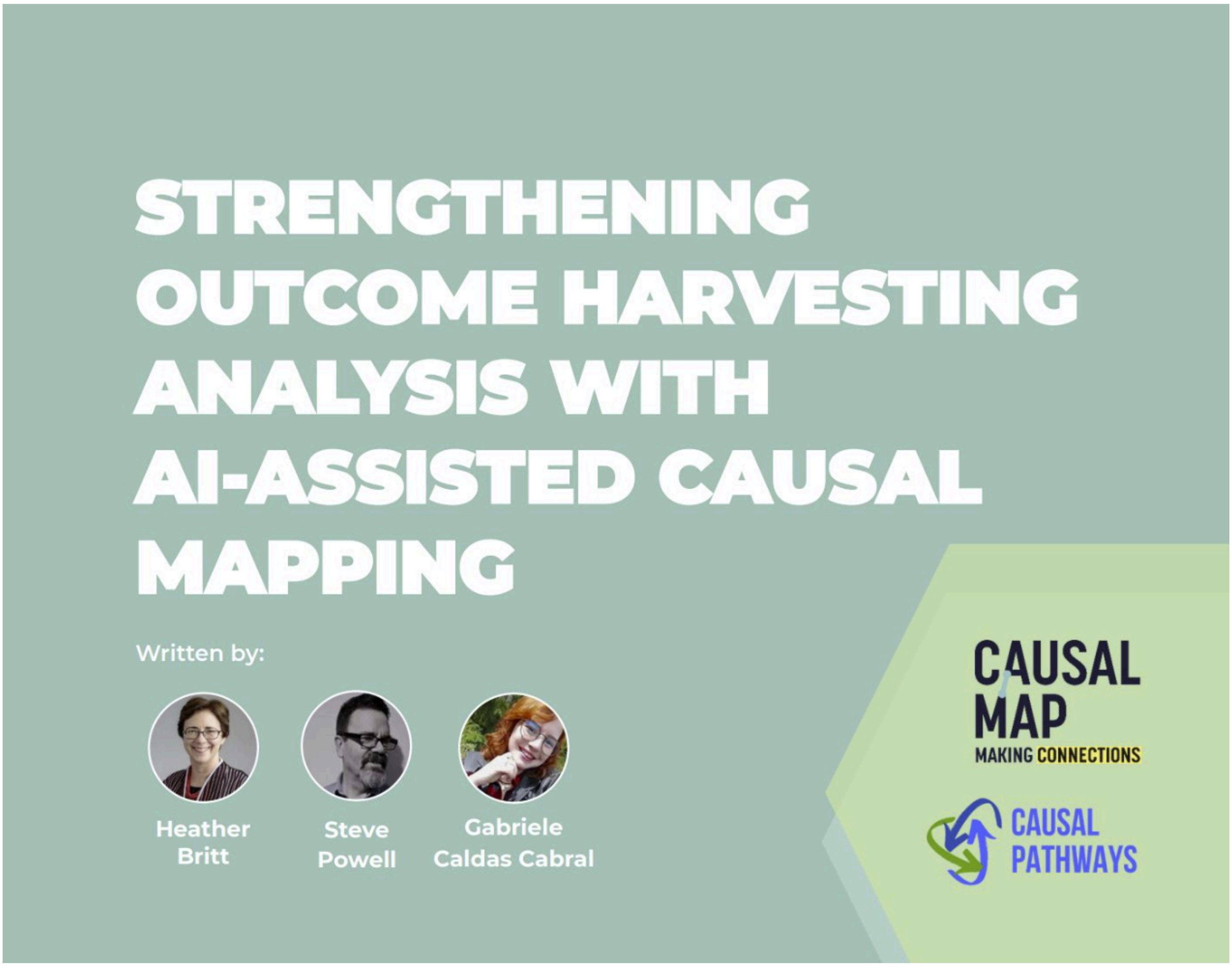
Evaluation of an integrated agriculture and nutrition programme. 48 interviews, 8 focus groups. April to May 2021.

Request the report from BSDR (info@bathsdr.org).

🌻 Strengthening OH with causal mapping

📅 8 Jan 2026

2026-01-08



Here is a version of the final text. Check the official publication here

Strengthening Outcome Harvesting Analysis with AI-Assisted Causal Mapping - shortened full version

Written by: Heather Britt, Steve Powell, Gabriele Caldas Cabral

Summary

This case study explores how AI-assisted causal mapping can enhance Outcome Harvesting (OH) analysis by revealing interrelationships between outcomes and identifying new actors contributing to change. The pilot demonstrates how this approach provides actionable insights and strengthens causal relationship analysis in OH. It emphasizes the importance of a principle-led analysis plan and human expertise in guiding the AI process.

Introduction

Outcome Harvesting is a powerful approach for discovering emergent changes—whether predicted or unpredicted, positive or negative—and documenting how those changes occurred. While many methods capture changes in those directly involved with a project, OH captures changes farther down the causal pathway.

However, evaluators often struggle to explore interrelationships between multiple outcomes. This case study describes how an OH practitioner (Heather Britt) collaborated with causal mapping practitioners (Steve Powell and Gabriele Caldas) to expand causal contribution analysis in OH using an AI-assisted causal mapping app. They analyzed OH data from a completed education project.

Outcome Harvesting: Analysis Limitations

While OH documents causal pathways contributing to individual outcomes well, evaluators find it difficult to make sense of interrelationships between multiple outcomes and their causal pathways. This limits their ability to answer questions about causal contribution.

Current OH practice often uses descriptive statistics to summarize data by outcome components (e.g., types of change agents or social actors) and reports findings in charts. Another approach arranges outcomes on a timeline to determine logical relationships.

Our pilot explores whether AI-assisted causal mapping can address these limitations by analyzing causal relationships between outcomes.

The Pilot

Core Question

Can AI-assisted causal mapping address the limitations of OH analysis?

Heather Britt reached out to Steve Powell and Gabriele Caldas to explore whether causal mapping with the Causal Map app could enhance OH analysis.

Causal mapping techniques, developed over 50 years ago, have been used across disciplines to identify and visually represent causal relationships in qualitative data. The Causal Map app computerizes this technique, allowing efficient coding, analysis, and visualization of information from multiple sources (interviews, reports, surveys, narratives), either manually or with AI assistance.

The AI-assisted capacities of the app were critical for revealing interrelationships between multiple outcomes.

Pilot Data Set

The pilot used data from the final evaluation of an education project (Girls Education project, 2016–2021) disrupted by political turmoil and COVID-19. The project adapted activities during lockdown, and OH was used to capture outcomes in five domains where the theory of change was no longer valid.

The evaluation team interviewed 49 change agents and drafted 103 outcome descriptions across five domains. The pilot data included both interview transcripts and outcome descriptions.

For the pilot, the domain **Increased community support for education** was selected, with 13 outcome descriptions analyzed.

Analysis Process

Step 1: Draft a Principle-Led Analysis Plan

Three guiding principles steered analysis decisions:

1. **Prioritize local leadership:** Use AI while keeping sensemaking and learning in the hands of local evaluators.
2. **Protect OH integrity:** Adapt methods as needed while staying true to OH principles, including “Less is more” (avoid collecting more data than can be analyzed).

3. **Produce accurate, actionable maps:** Human judgment is required to error-check data and interpret maps.

Step 2: Segment Data by Outcome Domain

Segmenting data by domain increases the likelihood of finding coherent causal pathways and facilitates error-checking. The pilot focused on one domain to analyze causal relationships between outcomes.

Step 3: Decide When to Apply AI-Assisted Causal Mapping

The pilot compared applying causal mapping to interview transcripts versus outcome descriptions. Outcome descriptions, crafted by local evaluators, were more accurate and required less error-checking than transcripts. Thus, mapping outcome descriptions was preferred to preserve local leadership and OH integrity.

Findings from Causal Maps

Relationships Between Outcomes

The AI identified causal links between the 13 outcome descriptions, revealing that outcomes influenced one another. For example, parents actively supporting home learning and leaders convincing parents to participate were central factors.

Factors Contributing to Domain-Level Outcome

Mapping revealed additional actors influencing the domain-level outcome “Community supports learning,” including unexpected contributors like Ministry officials.

Conclusion

AI-assisted causal mapping advanced OH analysis beyond descriptive statistics by:

- Analyzing multiple outcomes to determine causal contributions.
- Revealing interrelationships between causal pathways.
- Confirming known change agents and identifying unexpected influences.
- Showing how domain-level changes contribute to broader changes.

Causal mapping offers rich, flexible analysis that can be explored in multiple ways to answer diverse evaluation questions.

🌻 Tearfund

19 Sep 2022

2022-09-19

Summary

Causal Map was used to visualise and analyse data for several evaluations of Tearfund's Church & Community Mobilisation programme, across Bolivia, Sierra Leone and Uganda. These data sets were then combined within Causal Map to allow for a cross-country analysis of the data. The work also included research on church-led community poverty alleviation (Active Churches and Poverty).

🌻 Thinking together within and beyond Communities of Practice

📅 6 Feb 2024

2024-02-06

Summary

Christoph Jaschek, a student at the MSc in Systems Thinking in Practice at The Open University, used Causal Map to analyse semi-structured interviews for his Masters thesis.

The research was based on an exemplar case study conducted in August and September 2023 in a German non-governmental organisation. It employed a qualitative research design and included ten semi-structured interviews with the staff of the case study organisation. The aim of the research was to generate recommendations for the Management Team of the case study organisation to improve existing social learning spaces and to create a new social learning space.

Using a dialectical approach, the dissertation examined the interview material not only systematically but also systemically by means of causal mapping.

See the full thesis here

Reference: Jaschek, C. (2024). Thinking together within and beyond Communities of Practice (T802-23B: Research project, M.Sc. in Systems Thinking in Practice). The Open University.

1:1 meetings

Causal map, V1, 10.11.2023

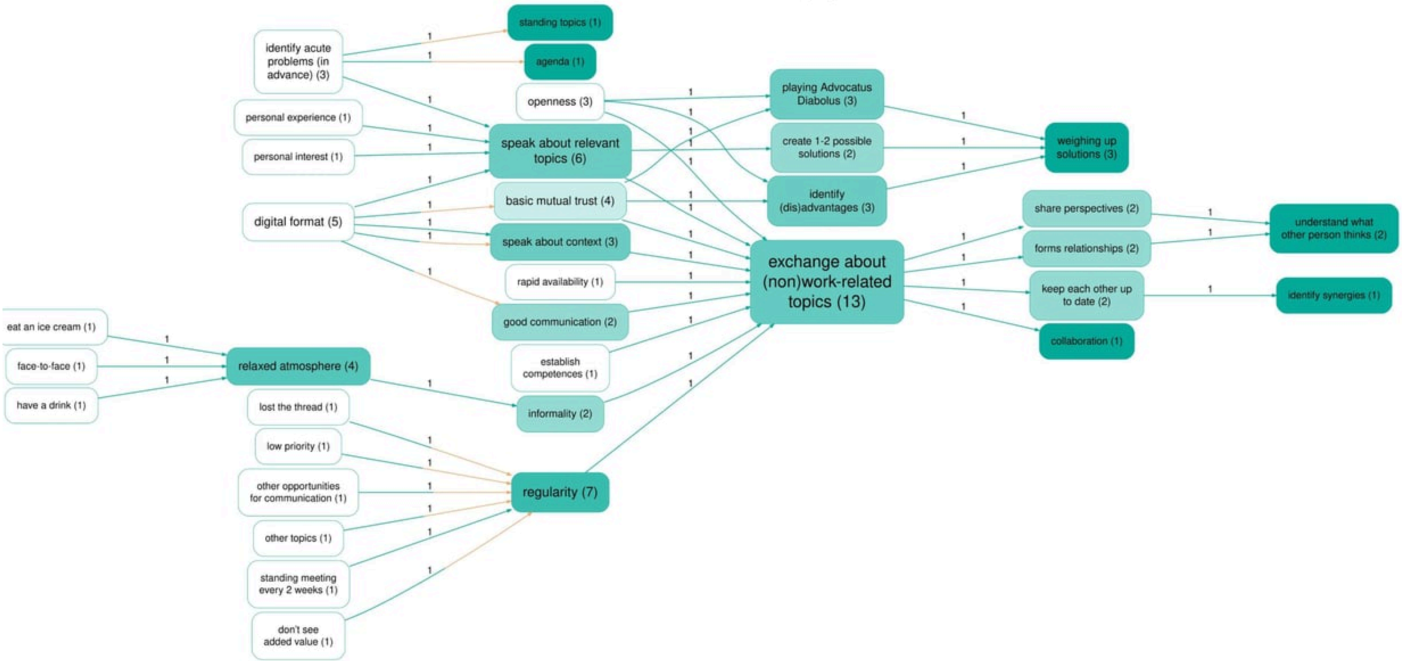


Figure 4.5: Causal Map: 1:1 meetings

Christoph Jaschek 49 L4562898

See the full thesis here

🌻 Together for Change, Solvacare

19 Sep 2022

2022-09-19

Summary

Solva Care is a registered charity set up by the community residing in the parish of Solva and Whitchurch in Pembrokeshire, Wales. They are committed to building and sustaining a vibrant, strong and connected community, by working closely with their Community Council and other local groups and organisations. This exploratory study contributes to those objectives and links with key areas of work for the multi sectoral partnership.

Request the report from Causal Map (hello@causalmap.app).

🌻 Tree Aid - Empowering Communities Through Forest Management in Burkina Faso

12 Dec 2025

2025-12-12 11/12/2025

Summary

Background: Causal Map partnered with Tree Aid to evaluate their Local Governance of Forest Resources (WEOOG PAANI) project in Burkina Faso. We used QuIP to collect the data and AI-assisted causal mapping to assess the project's impact on forest governance, household and food consumption amongst project beneficiaries in two communes.

Findings: The study revealed how integrating forest management with economic empowerment and sustainable agricultural practices, has contributed to community-driven environmental conservation. And it also demonstrated how combining qualitative research with analysis tools (Causal Map app) can provide insights into community development projects.

The partner

Between February and August 2024, Causal Map has worked with Tree Aid to conduct a comprehensive evaluation of their BB6 project in Burkina Faso, focusing on 2 communes (Toécé and Gomponsom). Tree Aid is an international NGO dedicated to protecting dryland forests and supporting communities in the African drylands.

The challenge

The WEOOG PAANI project (known as BB6) aimed to improve forest governance, household incomes, and food consumption across two communes, Toécé and Gomponsom. Tree Aid needed to understand the project's complex impact pathways, specifically, how integrating forest management with economic empowerment influenced community-driven conservation.

They faced the challenge of synthesising diverse qualitative narratives to answer specific research questions, such as:

- How do impact pathways differ between the two communes?
- What is the specific impact of the intervention on women's lives?
- Why is the project directly related to increased crop yield?
- Are there unexpected outcomes?

The Causal Map solution

Causal Map provided extensive support throughout the evaluation process.

Training

To be able to conduct quality Qualitative Impact Protocol (QuIP) interviews, training sessions were held with the evaluation team:

1. **QuIP Lead Evaluator:** the main researchers participated in the training held by Bath SDR to learn how to design and manage a QuIP study.
2. **Causal Mapping training:** A 2-day immersive training in Bristol focused on understanding causal mapping, developing interviewing skills, and preparing research deliverables.
3. **Field researchers training:** Causal Map prepared the training script. Tree Aid staff who completed the first two trainings then trained the field research team in Burkina Faso, applying concepts and techniques from the previous sessions.
4. **Causal Map app training:** After data analysis, Causal Map introduced Tree Aid analysts to use the Causal Map app, enabling deeper dives into the data.

Research Design and Data collection

We helped the Tree Aid team to develop the research design, including the research questions and the interview guides.

During the data collection phase, we provided ongoing support and feedback to the Field Researchers team. This ensured:

- Consistency in interview techniques
- Adherence to QuIP methodology
- Quality and depth of collected data
- Timely addressing of any challenges encountered in the field

Analysis

The evaluation employed the QuIP methodology, which involved:

- 31 interviews, including household interviews, focus group discussions, and key informant interviews;

- Causal mapping analysis using AI-assisted coding in the Causal Map App;
- Examination of outcomes across four domains: food consumption, income, forest management, and household dynamics.

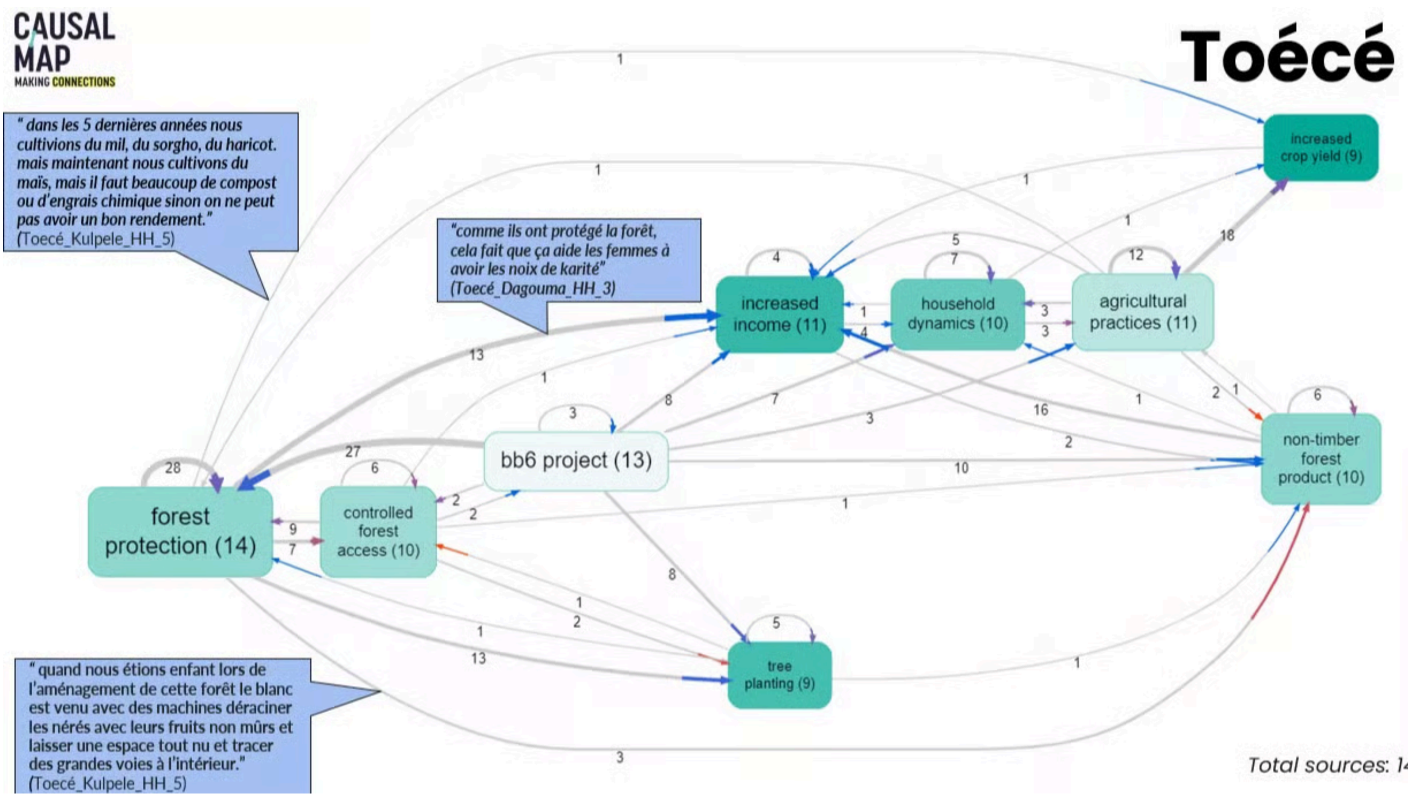
Results

Using the Causal Map app we were able to find 1288 causal claims (links) made by the respondents and we also autocoded the sentiment of each link in order to show which contributions were "positive" (blue lines) and which were "negative" (red lines).

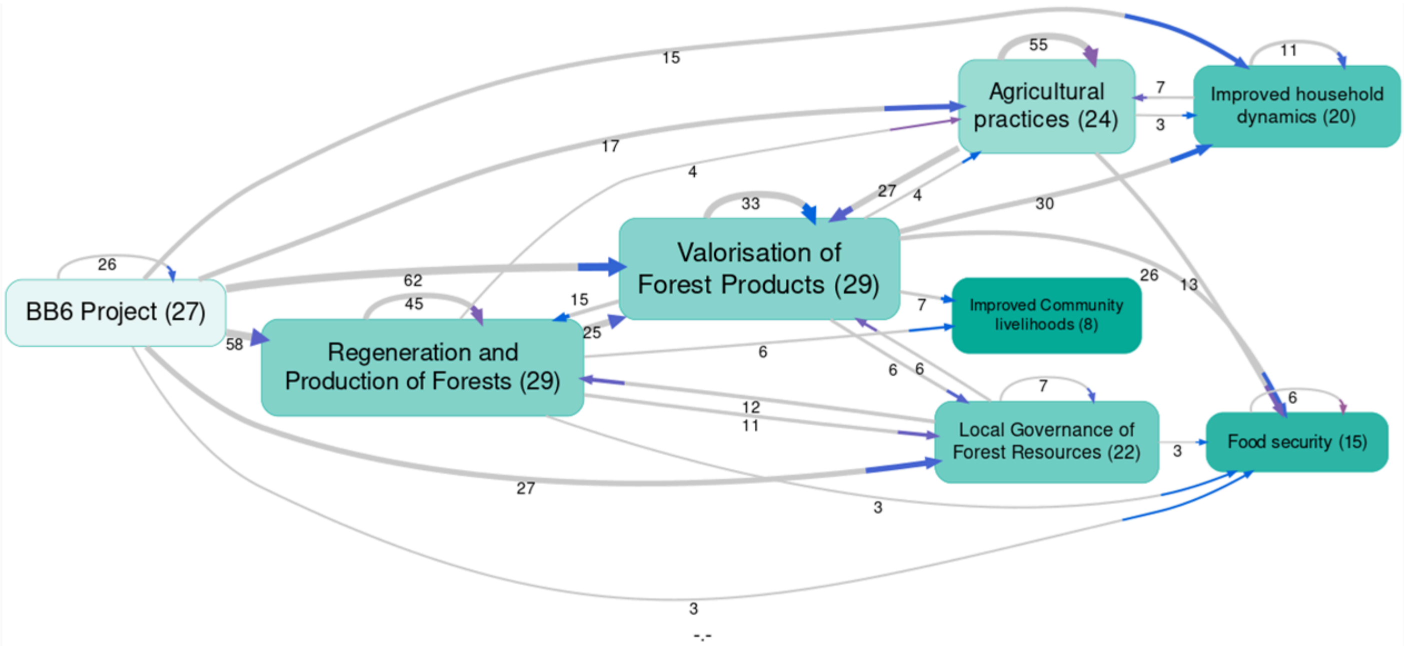
Through the different filters in the app, many maps and tables were created to support the quantitative data collected by Tree Aid, including:

- **Comparing** maps by commune
- **Splitting** and comparing data by type of interview and domain
- **Focusing** on specific themes, such as ‘Impact on women’s lives’
- **Unpacking** unexpected outcomes and **answering** research questions, i.e. ‘Why BB6 project is directly related to increased crop yield?’

The evidence strongly suggests that Tree Aid BB6 project has demonstrated significant **positive impacts** on the communities in Toécé and Gomponsom. By integrating forest management with economic empowerment and sustainable agricultural practices, the project has created a model for community-driven environmental conservation. The strengthened local governance structures and improved household dynamics suggest that these positive changes may be sustainable in the long term.



Using the “soft recoding” feature in the Causal Map app allowed us to create maps showing different perspectives of stakeholders' stories. This innovative approach enabled us to compare narratives against the project’s Theory of Change and verify the project's impacts across various domains.



🌻 UNDP Chile

📅 **19 Sep 2022**

2022-09-19

Summary

This qualitative impact evaluation of the Local Children's Office Pilot Program reported on the effect that the program had during the year 2021 in a group of 94 beneficiary families and a specific group of 13 children and adolescents who were benefited.

🌻 UNICEF Innocenti. Qualitative Study of the Social Cash Transfer Programme in Urban Zambia

📅 16 Apr 2025

2025-04-16

Summary

The Social Cash Transfer (SCT) programme in Zambia is a poverty-targeted social protection intervention. It's the country's largest and most important programme of its category and it was established with the main purpose of reducing extreme poverty and intergenerational transfer of poverty. It targeted 5 categories of households, providing cash payments.

The study

BSDR has conducted a study (using QuIP, Qualitative Impact Protocol) based on interviews with 96 cash transfer recipients to assess the impact of the programme, focusing on the main changes experienced by beneficiary households in urban, periurban and rural areas as a result of their participation in the programme. Causal Map was used to analyse the interviews and generate causal maps.

Figure 35: Drivers of positive income outcomes

Map showing links with at least five sources

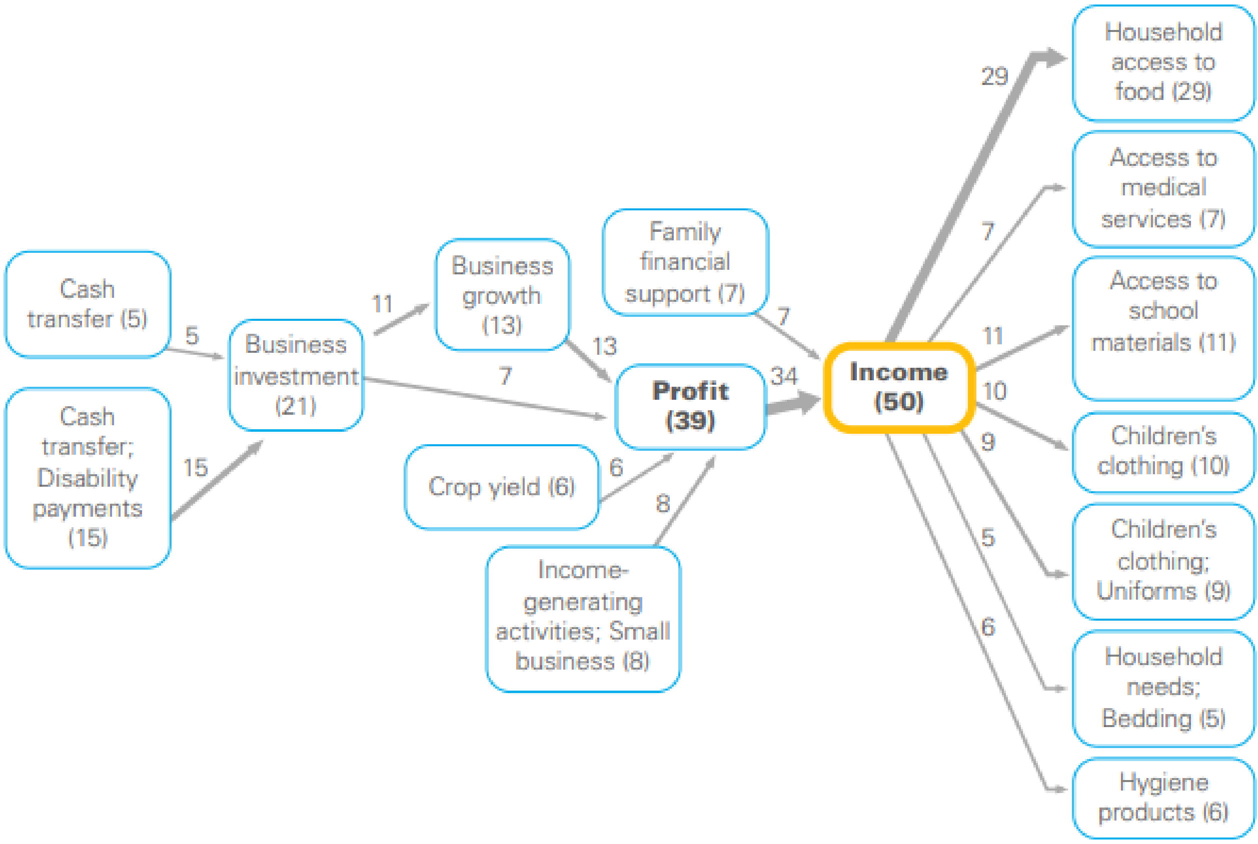
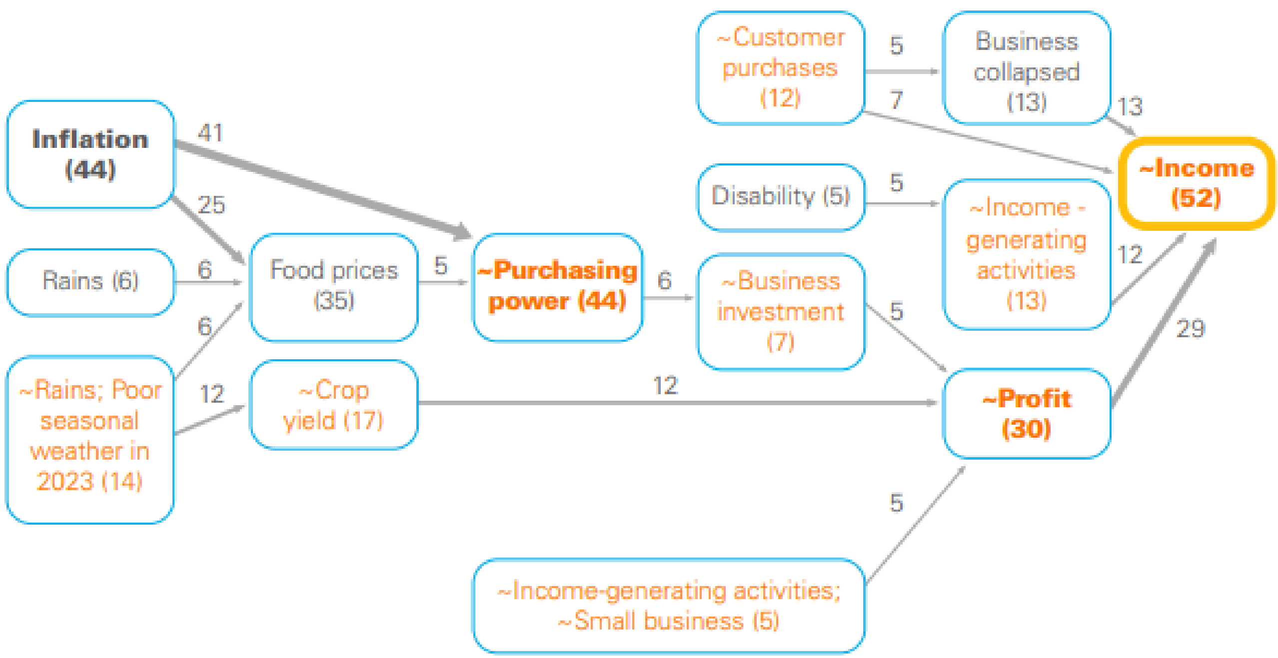


Figure 36: Barriers to income generation

Map showing links with at least five sources



Check the report here

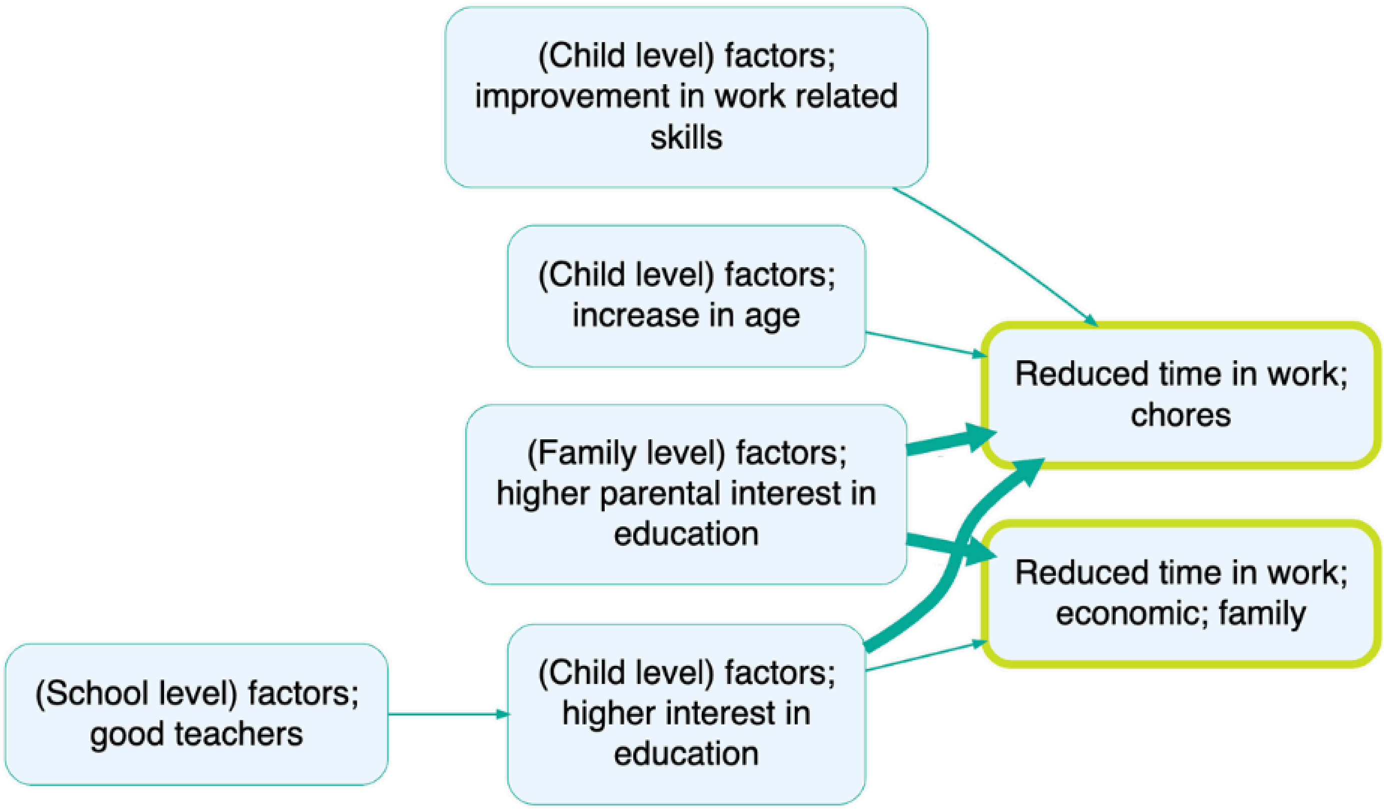
🌻 UNICEF study uses Causal Map to explore complex drivers of child work in India

📅 18 Jun 2025

2025-06-18## Summary{.banner}

We are pleased to see how the UNICEF Innocenti team, in collaboration with Bath SDR and Young Lives India, has used Causal Map to analyse and unpack the complex issue of child work and schooling in India. Their recently released research provides an example of how our software can help synthesise qualitative data into clear, actionable insights.

The study



The research team conducted the Qualitative Impact Protocol methodology in interviews with children and their caregivers in Bihar and Telangana and analysed them using Causal Map. By using Causal Map, the team was able to move beyond a simple list of factors to create a dynamic model of the system behind child work and schooling.

Many respondents made causal connections between education and child work. For example, according to some respondents in both locations, leaving school led to adolescents starting paid work. Children and young people often left education due to financial difficulties or absence, illness or death of a family member. Parents reported that school closures due to COVID-19 also led to school dropout.

The study's results provided clear insights into children's daily lives, leading the research team to recommend a multi-sectoral approach. They proposed changes to both policies and programs to improve school engagement and address the effects of child labour.

For more information on this study, please see Bath SDR's blog post and check out the briefs and full reports.

🌻 Using AI to facilitate feedback on the learning experiences of doctoral students

📅 12 Dec 2025

2025-12-12

- Gabriele Cabral, Causal Map Ltd
- James Copestake, University of Bath
- Steve Powell, Causal Map Ltd

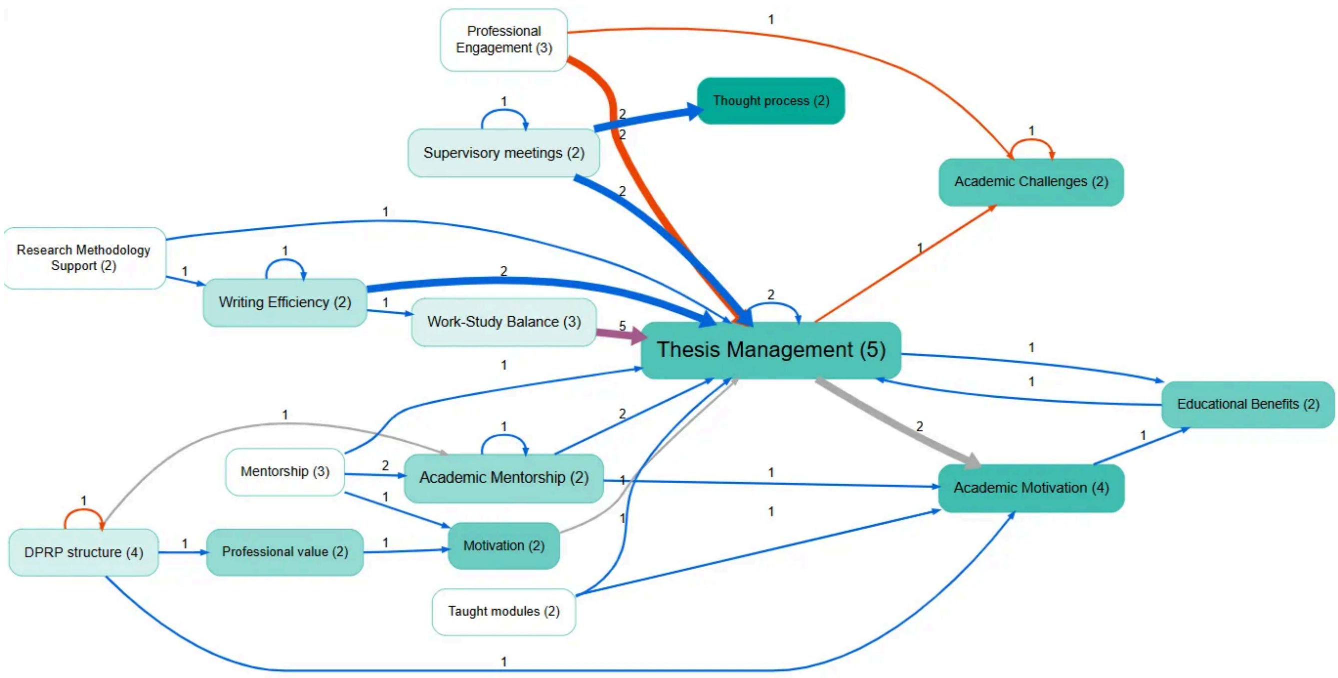
Summary

The Causal Map team has conducted a trial of an innovative approach to securing feedback from students using online open-ended interviews conducted by the app QualiaInterviews, which uses generative AI (gen-AI), followed by a second use of gen-AI within the app **Causal Map** to semi-automate causal coding of the narrative transcripts thereby generated. The trial was conducted with students registered on the doctorate in policy research and practice (DPRP) at the **University of Bath.**

The pilot

We report on the trial of an innovative approach to securing feedback from students using online open-ended interviews conducted by the app Qualia, which uses generative AI (gen-AI), followed by a second use of gen-AI within the app Causal Map to semi-automate causal coding of the narrative transcripts thereby generated. The trial was conducted with students registered on the doctorate in policy research and practice (DPRP) at the University of Bath, a part-time programme for mid-career policy professionals. This generated credible evidence of diverse positive and negative drivers of learning from eleven students. The trial suggests that incorporation of gen-AI into causal mapping of narrative data about students' study experiences enhances the potential to use the method cost-effectively on a larger scale, whether alongside or instead of more traditional approaches to eliciting student feedback on teaching and learning.

Keywords: *AI; Causal mapping; Doctoral studies; Generative AI; Qualitative data analysis, Student evaluation*



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Numbers on factors show source count.. Factor sizes show citation count. Darker factor colours show greater outcomeness.
Numbers on links show citation count.
Zooming in to level 1 of the hierarchy. Auto clustering factors using label set 2. Top 20 factors by source count.

See our findings in this paper

See a summarised report in this presentation

🌻 Using QuIP and Causal Map in an Evaluation, a WFP interview with DeftEdge

📅 26 Sep 2024

2024-09-26 Alexandra Priebe (WFP), interviewing Ashley Hollister and Sarang Mangi (DeftEdge)

Summary

Earlier this year, the World Food Programme finalized the "Thematic Evaluation of WFP's Contribution to Market Development and Food Systems in Bangladesh and South Sudan from 2018 to 2022", which used the Qualitative Impact Assessment Protocol (QuIP) for primary data collection. Alexandra Priebe sat down with members of the evaluation team, Ashley Hollister and Sarang Mangi, from DeftEdge Corp., to talk about their experience with using Causal Map.

Using Causal Map to analyse QuIP data

Overall, I would say using the Causal Map app to analyse the QuIP data was a positive experience. The software itself was quite intuitive and helpful in providing us with an option to visualize the causal linkages in the pathways that emerged from the qualitative data collected from different types of respondents. It was particularly useful in allowing us to visualise how different factors influence each other. The strength of the links in the map is represented by the thickness of the lines, which increases depending on how many people indicated the same cause and effect relationship. The app also has the option to display the total counts as a label, which was quite helpful.

Learning curve

It does have a learning curve. The application becomes more efficient and easier to use if you have the notes and database set up in a format that's compatible with uploading. It is really useful to consider this as far back as the planning stage of the evaluation and understanding how the application is going to be used and how it functions, even when you're developing the QuIP protocols and the analysis plan. Which questions do you want to ask? How are you going to code responses? Is it going to be at the individual level or at the focus group level? How are you going to record notes? All of that should be decided in the beginning because all of that has to be done with the mindset of how this will go into this application.

The coding process

We did face some issues with the Causal Map app itself, but to resolve them, we reached out to the support team who were very much helpful and responsive. There is a WhatsApp group, which is actually quite useful. You can see the types of questions other people are asking and they resolve them quite quickly, getting back to you within an hour or two.

You can either open the application and import your data using an Excel or Word file, then go through your notes and create the codes within the application itself. We initially piloted having all of the data in the app first and tried coding in situ. However, in any results chain, you sometimes have a situation where an effect is also a cause, or you need to use the same terminology in both cause and effect to draw multiple links. We found it difficult to go back and search for what had been previously coded under "effect" if we then wanted to use it under "cause".

In the end, we prepared the data in Excel and uploaded it into Causal Map because that allowed us to quality control and make those large changes more efficiently.

Strengths and advantages of QuIP with Causal Map

There are benefits and limits to QuIP as a method. A benefit is getting a more nuanced perspective on the causal factors of changes experienced and how participants perceive what caused them. The double-blind aspect is the most unique but also the most complex aspect of QuIP in terms of maintaining it in its truest form.

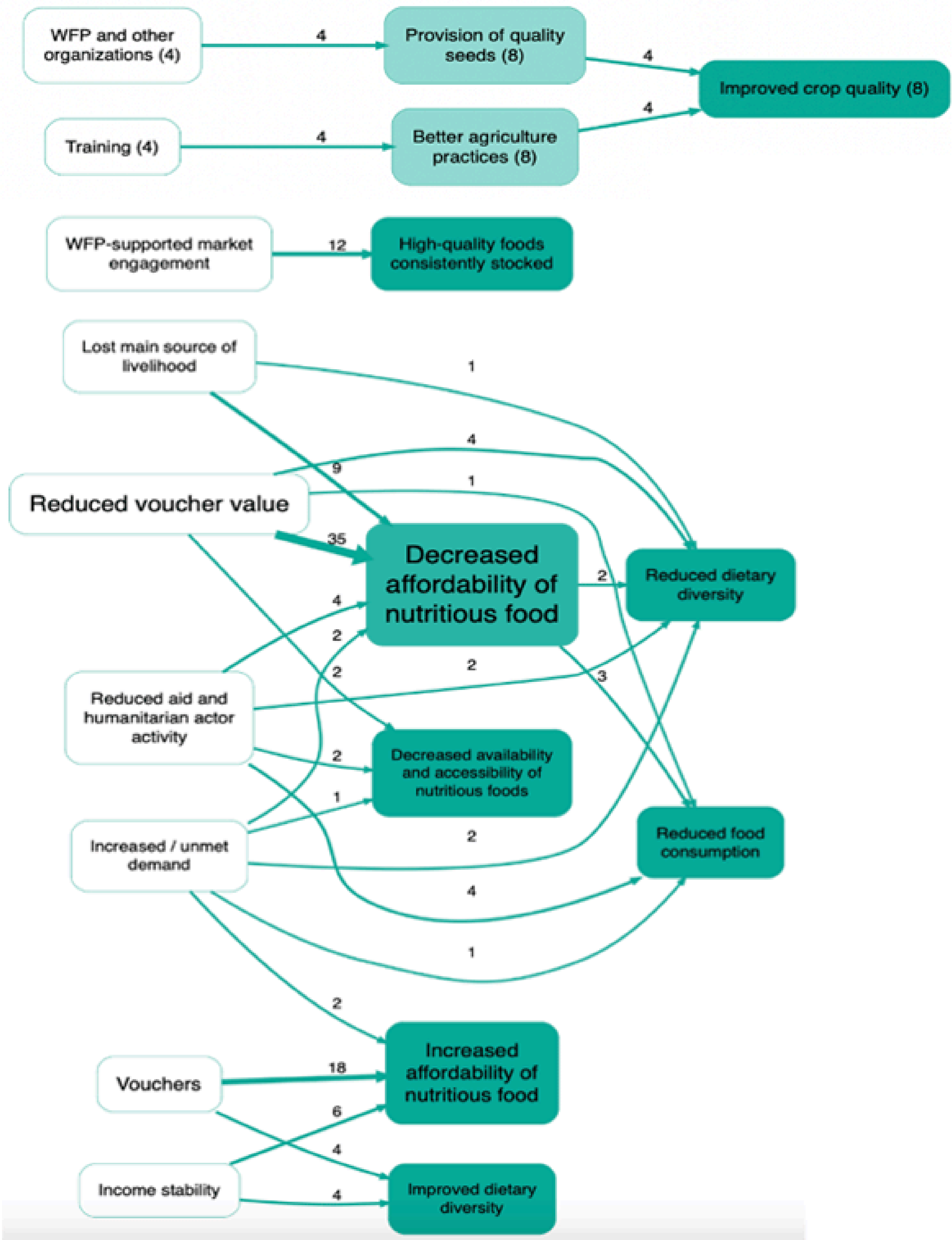
Causal Map provides a structured way to integrate and visualize all the findings collected through QuIP. It allows you to see all the linkages or set parameters for, say, the top 15 strongest linkages. The app offers features like filtering data based on specific criteria and merging similar codes.

However, from a methodological perspective, the causal maps generated in Causal Map are not as scientifically robust as maps that might be created using more quantitative techniques, such as structural equation modelling (SEM). The causal maps in Causal Map are based more on the subjective perceptions and experiences of the respondents, as interpreted by the researcher.

Advice for other evaluators

First, be very clear on the intention of using QuIP and Causal Map and integrate this clearly into the evaluation matrix and data analysis plan. Make sure that the team has the necessary capacity, and check this in the evaluation timeframe.

Another lesson learned is that having fewer, broader questions and interviewing more people would probably be more advantageous. This approach allows more time to dig into what changes are happening and why, while also simultaneously gathering enough information to have links drawn in the Causal Map.



Check the report here See more details here

🌻 Voscur

19 Sep 2022

2022-09-19

Summary

VOSCUR are a Bristol-based charity who support organisations in the voluntary, community and social enterprise (VCSE) sector.

Causal Map was used to create maps showing, for example, the influences and consequences of access to increased funding.

Request the report from BSDR (info@bathsdr.org).

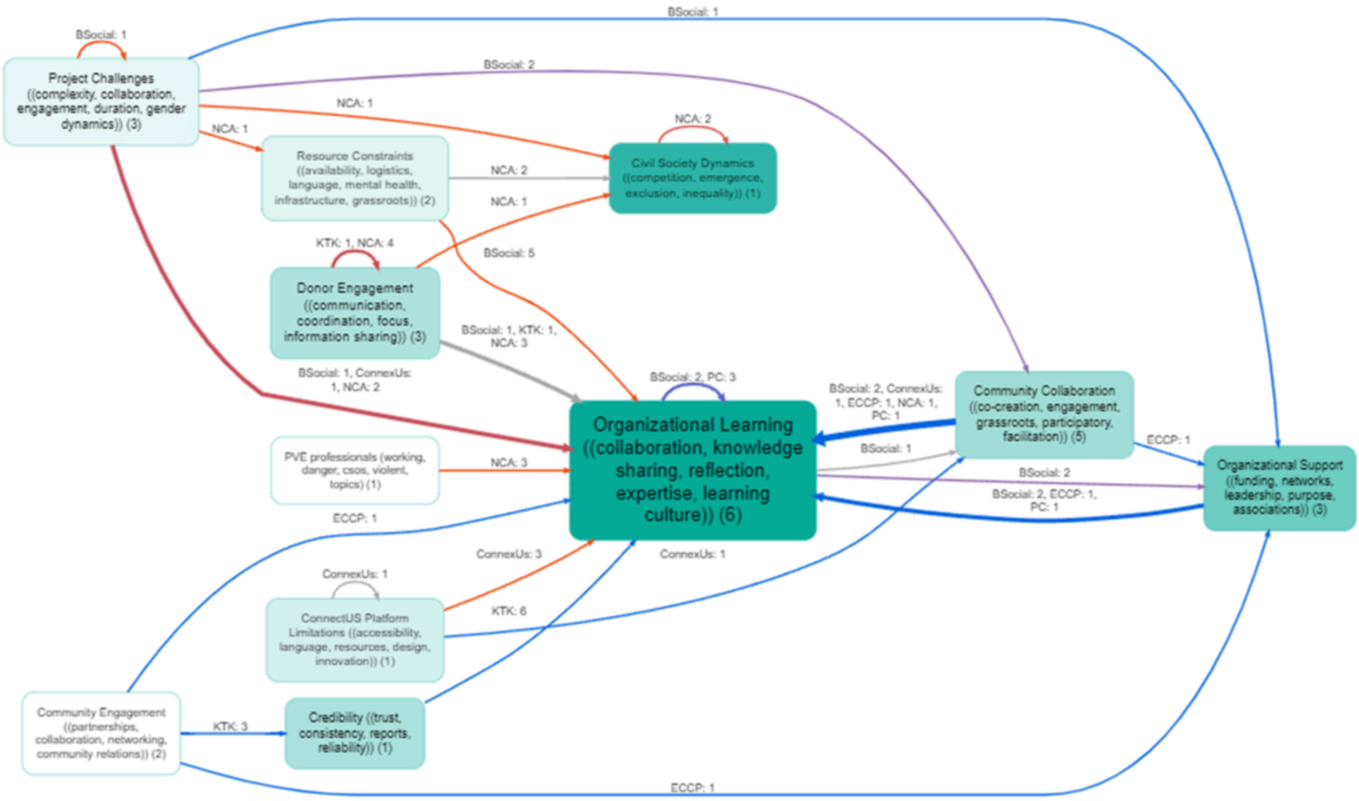
🌻 What drives group learning, PLI

📅 10 Mar 2023

2023-03-10

Summary

Causal Map was commissioned in March 2024 to analyse excerpts from thematic summaries made for each of 7 case studies about conditions that foster and hinder group learning in an international development setting, focusing on INGOs.



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Numbers on factors show source count.. Factor sizes show citation count. Darker factor colours show greater outcomeness.
Numbers on links show citation tally: source_id.
Zooming in to level 1 of the hierarchy. Auto clustering factors using label set 5. Top 11 factors by citation count. Showing only links with at least 1 sources.

🌻 World Concern. Evaluating a Holistic Community Development Program with QuIP and Causal mapping

9 May 2025

2025-05-09

Summary

Background: World Concern, a non-profit serving neglected communities in Africa, Asia, and Haiti, used qualitative causal mapping to evaluate their One Village Transformed (OVT) initiative. OVT uses a holistic strategy that evaluates the physical and spiritual needs of communities while also recognising and building on their unique strengths, available resources, and core values.

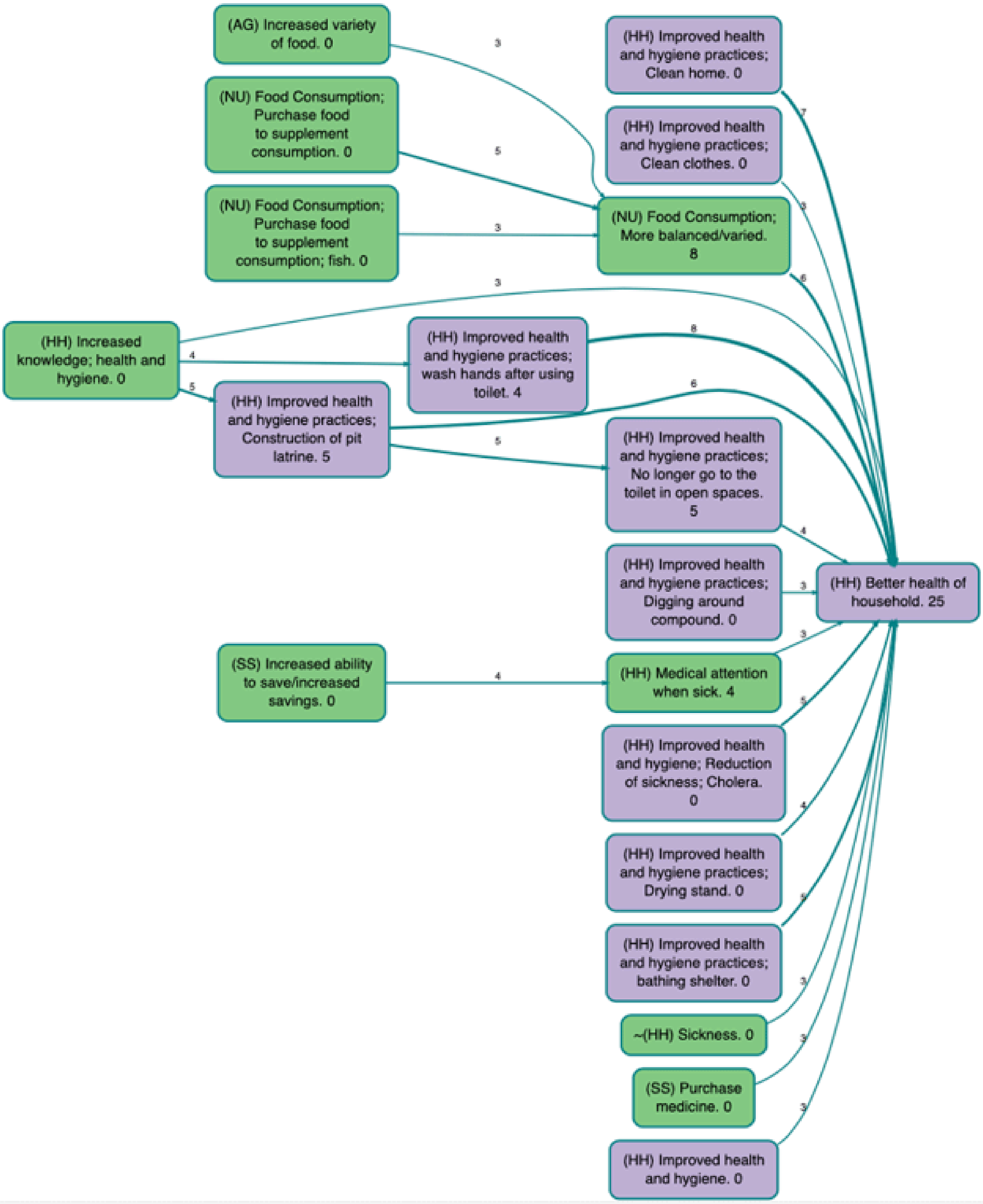
Findings: By applying QuIP methodology and causal mapping to data from Uganda and South Sudan, they uncovered the pathways of change, key drivers, and outcomes shaping community transformation. The findings have shaped the way OVT and other programs are designed and implemented.

The partner

World Concern engaged Edessa Research Consultants (ERC) to design and carry out a Qualitative Impact Protocol (QuIP) study in Uganda and South Sudan.

The Causal Map solution

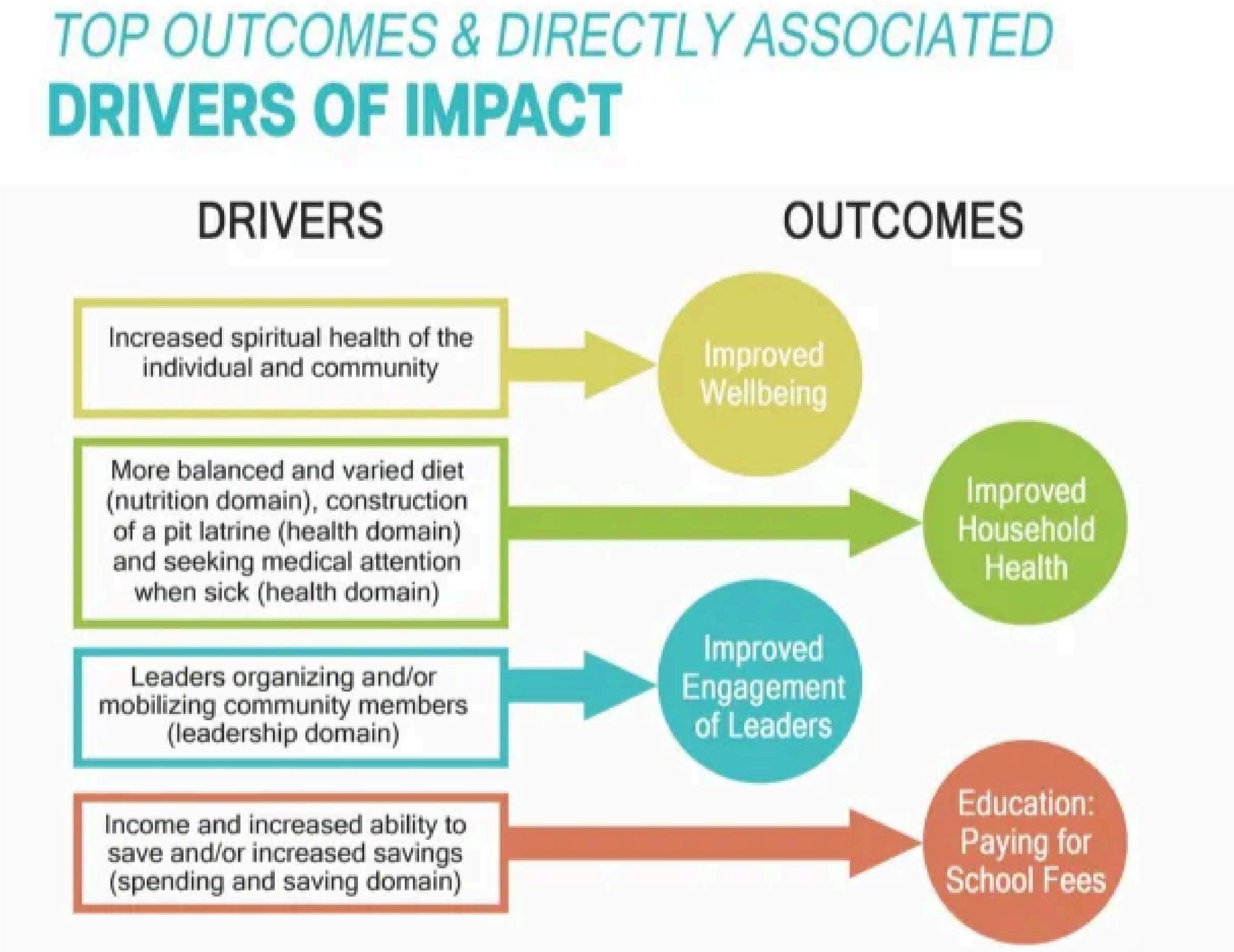
Causal Map was used to analyse the data collected with QuIP and causal maps for each source and region were generated, including the top 20 most cited causal links, the most frequent drivers and outcomes and domain-specific maps.



The Bath SDR and Causal Map teams advise caution when using percentages with small sample sizes, like in this study. In situations like this, we prefer to use simple response numbers in charts instead. We also recommend keeping individual interviews and focus groups separate in aggregate maps to prevent ambiguity regarding the significance of each source.

Results

Causal maps were used to identify pathways of change, drivers and outcomes, both positive and negative.



In a blog post written by EIG Insights and World Concern to Bath SDR, the researchers mentioned that the findings of this study have shaped the way OVT and other programs are designed and implemented, seeking to address gaps that were identified while also building on what was shown to be working well.

Check the summarised version of the report here See a detailed blog post about the study

🌻 World Food Programme, Forcier Consulting

19 Sep 2022

2022-09-19

Summary

The Causal Map App contributed to the evaluation of the World Food Programme (WFP) market development activities and related food systems support activities in Southern Africa from 2018 to 2021.

Data from key informant interviews and focus group discussions with retailers in four countries (Lesotho, Malawi, Mozambique, and Zimbabwe) were coded and mapped out using Causal Map to illustrate trends, anomalies, and possible entry points. The WFP used maps and tables from the app to clearly visualise the research findings in their report.

See the full report here